

TOEFL iBT 2026 · 132-Day Sprint Plan

Personal study plan

2026-05-17 → 2026-09-26

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TOEFL iBT 2026 · 130-Day Sprint Plan

Exam date: 2026-09-26 (Saturday), 08:00 AM **Start date:** 2026-05-18 (Monday) **Total:** 130 days / ~19 weeks / 9 bi-weekly chapters + 4-day final taper (+ 9/25 rest day, 9/26 exam) **Target score:** 100+ (CEFR C1) **Daily commitment:** 90 minutes

0 · Why this book exists

On **2026-01-21**, ETS launched a completely redesigned **Adaptive TOEFL iBT**. The exam you'll sit in September is this new version — not an updated old TOEFL but a different game with different rules:

Total length - Old: ~120 min - **New: 90 min**

Reading / Listening - Old: Fixed items - **New: Adaptive — Module 1 difficulty determines Module 2**

Speaking tasks - Old: 4 tasks (Independent + Integrated) - **New: 2 tasks — Listen & Repeat (7 items) + Interview (4 items)**

Speaking prep time - Old: Yes - **New: None**

Writing tasks - Old: Integrated + Academic Discussion - **New: Build a Sentence + Email + Academic Discussion**

Score - Old: 0–120 - **New: 1–6 CEFR band** (0–120 also reported for 2 years)

Score delivery - Old: 6–10 days - **New: 72 hours**

Templated answers - Old: Workable - **New: AI detects them → penalty**

Three rules that run through every chapter:

1. **Early items are not equal.** The adaptive engine punishes Module 1 mistakes more heavily. All “accuracy training” in this book targets the early items.
2. **Real input beats drill.** ETS's own research (Liu, 2014; see resources.md § 7, R-REF-1) found coaching attendance has near-zero correlation with score. **Total real-English exposure** is the main driver. Every week includes real material (academic podcasts, TED, Coursera).
3. **No templates.** The new AI scorer penalizes templated language. This book trains **structural thinking** (Email 4-part frame, Discussion PEEL reasoning) — not phrases to memorize.

1 · Methodology (evidence-based)

1.1 Shadowing

Originated in 1990s Japanese/Korean EFL pedagogy. Meta-analyses (Hamada 2016; Tandfonline 2025 systematic review) show: - **10–15 min/day × 4–6 weeks →**

measurable gains in listening comprehension, fluency, pronunciation - **Directly maps** to Listen & Repeat (the new 7/11 Speaking items) - This book reserves **15 min/day for shadowing**. See `resources.md` § 4 for sources and the 3-pass protocol.

1.2 Spaced repetition (Anki)

- Vocabulary is the floor; everything else stacks on it.
- Decks: **4000 Essential English Words** (general) + **Barron's Essential Words for the TOEFL** (academic).
- 15 min/day = 20 new + ~60 reviews. See `resources.md` § 3.

1.3 Adaptive test strategy

- **Module 1 accuracy > speed**. Push hard early to unlock harder Module 2 (= higher ceiling).
- **Error log with attribution**. For every wrong answer, tag it: *knowledge gap* / *careless* / *time pressure*. Careless errors hurt most.
- **No templates**. But do learn **frames**: Email (greeting → context → ask → close), Discussion (Point → Evidence → Explain → Link).

1.4 AI tool stack

Picked one per role; see `resources.md` § 2 for full catalog.

- **Official mock + scoring**: ETS TestReady — only platform with the actual scoring engine
 - **Conversational speaking coach**: PrepEx (Petra AI) — fixes the “no prep time” problem; live dialogue
 - **Cross-section AI scoring**: FluentPrep AI — ETS-rubric-aligned, 900+ items
 - **Vocabulary**: Anki + shared decks — proven spaced-repetition algorithm
 - **Writing polish**: ChatGPT / Claude — grammar/idea feedback only; **never trust their scores**
 - **Shadowing source**: TED-Ed / 60-Second Science — transcript-bundled, ~C1 register
-

2 · The 90-Minute Daily Template (the iron rule)

2.1 Daily time blocks

00:00–00:15	■ Anki vocabulary	(20 new + ~60 reviews)
← every day		
00:15–00:30	■ Shadowing	(Listening + Speaking combined)
← every day		
00:30–01:00	■ Day's MAIN skill	(30 min – rotates per § 2.2)
01:00–01:20	■ Day's SECONDARY skill	(20 min – rotates per § 2.2)
01:20–01:30	■ Error log	(3 lines: what / why / how to avoid next time)

Note: **Anki already covers vocabulary (foundation for all 4 skills). Shadowing already trains Listening + Speaking simultaneously.** So the “Main + Secondary” 30+20-min blocks are **additional** focused work on top of those two foundations.

2.2 Weekly skill rotation (iron rule: all four skills touched every week)

- **Monday** · MAIN = Reading (30 min) · SECONDARY = Writing (20 min) · Touches: R, W, L+S (shadowing)
- **Tuesday** · MAIN = Listening (30 min) · SECONDARY = Speaking (20 min) · Touches: L, S, L+S
- **Wednesday** · MAIN = Writing (30 min) · SECONDARY = Reading (20 min) · Touches: W, R, L+S
- **Thursday** · MAIN = Speaking (30 min) · SECONDARY = Listening (20 min) · Touches: S, L, L+S
- **Friday** · MAIN = Reading (30 min) · SECONDARY = Speaking (20 min) · Touches: R, S, L+S
- **Saturday** · MAIN = Listening + Speaking combined (30 min) · SECONDARY = Writing (20 min) · Touches: L, S, W
- **Sunday** · MAIN = Writing — Email or Discussion (30 min) · SECONDARY = Short mock + weekly review (20 min) · Touches: W + full skill recap

Weekly focused touches (MAIN + SECONDARY + combined): R×3, L×3, W×4, S×4 (combined L+S counted once for each) ⇒ **every skill ≥ 3 focused sessions per week.**

2.3 Sunday extra: review + short mock

Sundays use 30 min for a short mock-style segment (~10 reading items OR 8 listening items OR 1 writing task), pulled from any free source in resources.md § 5 (Magoosh, TestSucceed, TestReady free items). Remaining time on error-log review. This is where weekly practice **converts into score**.

2.4 The floor rules

- **Anki + Shadowing never get skipped.** They are the floor. Break either for 3 consecutive days and the whole system collapses.
 - **The error log matters more than item count.** Practice without review = zero.
-

3 · 9 Chapters + 1 Week — Roadmap

 **Important:** Each chapter's "theme" is an **emphasis on top of** the weekly rotation — not "this chapter only practices one skill." The § 2.2 rotation is always in effect. The chapter theme just shifts MAIN sessions toward the focus skill.

Ch.1 — 5/18 to 5/31 (14 days) - Emphasis: Diagnosis + system setup (4-skill baseline) - Deliverable: Weak-skill profile + tools live

Ch.2 — 6/1 to 6/14 (14 days) - Emphasis: Listening + high-frequency vocabulary - Deliverable: Listening baseline (free TestReady/Magoosh items)

Ch.3 — 6/15 to 6/28 (14 days) - Emphasis: Reading + academic vocabulary - Deliverable: Reading Module 1 $\geq 85\%$ accuracy

Ch.4 — 6/29 to 7/12 (14 days) - Emphasis: Speaking — Listen & Repeat focus - Deliverable: 7-item exact-repeat rate $\geq 80\%$

Ch.5 — 7/13 to 7/26 (14 days) - Emphasis: Writing — Email + Build a Sentence - Deliverable: Email 100 words in 10 min

Ch.6 — 7/27 to 8/9 (14 days) - Emphasis: Speaking — Interview + AI dialogue - Deliverable: Structured 45-sec Interview answer

Ch.7 — 8/10 to 8/23 (14 days) - Emphasis: Writing — Academic Discussion - Deliverable: 200-word Discussion in 10 min

Ch.8 — 8/24 to 9/6 (14 days) - Emphasis: Adaptive realism — Module 1 mastery
- Deliverable: 4-skill Module 1 accuracy on target

Ch.9 — 9/7 to 9/20 (14 days) - Emphasis: Full mocks ×4 + error attribution -
Deliverable: Stable mock score ≥ 100

Final Taper — 9/21 to 9/24 (4 days) - Emphasis: Pre-exam tune-up + state management (taper week compressed) - Deliverable: Peak on exam morning

Pre-exam rest — 9/25 Fri (off — Anki maintenance only, no new content) **Exam day — 9/26 Sat 08:00**

What “emphasis” means in practice: in Ch.2 (Listening focus week), the Sunday “MAIN = Writing” slot temporarily becomes a “Listening micro-mock,” and Shadowing source switches to lecture-style audio. Across the week, Listening focused touches rise while **Reading, Writing, Speaking each still get ≥ 3 focused sessions** + daily Shadowing + daily Anki. Each chapter’s intro restates its modified weekly schedule.

4 · Evaluation Checkpoints (don’t skip)

Baseline mock — Days 2–3 (5/19–20) - What: Full mock using R-OFF-2 (ETS Sample Test Jan 2026) - Target: Get a starting score

Milestone 1 — End of Ch.3 (6/28) - What: Reading Module 1 only - Target: ≥ 85% accuracy

Milestone 2 — End of Ch.5 (7/26) - What: Listening + Speaking Listen-and-Repeat combined - Target: Listening ≥ 24/30 raw, L&R ≥ 80% exact

Milestone 3 — End of Ch.7 (8/23) - What: Writing — both tasks under exam time - Target: Email ≤ 10 min, Discussion ≤ 10 min

Mock weeks — Ch.9 (9/7–20) - What: 4 full mocks - Target: Stable total ≥ 100

Test day — 2026-09-26 08:00 - What: Real exam - Target: 100+

5 · Setup Checklist (do all of this on Day 1)

See resources.md § 8 for the full Day-1 setup list with exact URLs.

Quick summary: - ETS TestReady account (**R-OFF-1**) - Bookmark the free sample mock (**R-OFF-2**) for tomorrow - Anki desktop + import 4000 Essential English Words (**R-ANKI-1**) - One AI speaking tool — PrepEx (**R-AI-1**) or FluentPrep (**R-AI-2**) - Subscribe to 60-Second Science podcast (**R-SHAD-3**) - Choose where the error log lives (and don't switch)

6 • How to use this book

1. **Each morning:** open the current chapter file, tick today's checkboxes
 2. **Each evening:** add to the error log (3 lines is fine — *what / why / how to avoid*)
 3. **Every other Saturday:** complete the chapter's **bi-week review card** at the bottom of the chapter file
 4. **If you miss a target:** push the lagging task into next chapter's early days — don't force progress
 5. **Anki and Shadowing are not optional.** Anything else can be halved on a bad day; these two never stop.
-

7 • File map

toeflbook/	
— README.md	← you are here
— resources.md	← URLs, tools, decks (the catalog)
— ch01-diagnosis-and-system-setup.md	← 5/17–5/30
— ch02-listening-and-vocabulary.md	← 5/31–6/13
— ch03-reading-and-academic-vocab.md	← 6/14–6/27
— ch04-speaking-listen-and-repeat.md	← 6/28–7/11
— ch05-writing-email-and-sentence.md	← 7/12–7/25
— ch06-speaking-interview-and-ai.md	← 7/26–8/8
— ch07-writing-academic-discussion.md	← 8/9–8/22
— ch08-adaptive-module1-mastery.md	← 8/23–9/5
— ch09-full-mocks-and-attribution.md	← 9/6–9/19
— ch10-final-week.md	← 9/20–9/26

After all chapters are written, run pandoc to compile into a single PDF (build.sh will be included).

8 · References

- ETS TOEFL Research Series (Oct 2025 Technical Manual)
- Liu, O. L. (2014). *Investigating the Relationship Between Test Preparation and TOEFL iBT Performance*. ETS Research Report.
- Hamada, Y. (2016). *Shadowing: Who Benefits and How?* Language Teaching Research.
- ETS TOEFL TestReady (2026 adaptive version)
- Beyond English / Magoosh 2026 format guides

(Full URLs in resources.md § 7.)

Resources Catalog

Central index for every site, app, deck, and content source used in this book.
When a daily task says “Use **R-OFF-1**”, look it up here for the exact URL and how to use it.

0 · How to read the codes (R-XXX-N)

Every resource in this book has a short code like **R-OFF-1** or **R-FREE-3**. The chapters reference these codes instead of repeating full names + URLs. Format is **R-<category>-<number>**.

The 7 category prefixes:

- **R-OFF-** — **OFFicial** · ETS official materials · see § 1 · e.g. R-OFF-1 = ETS TestReady
- **R-AI-** — **AI** · AI feedback / scoring tools · see § 2 · e.g. R-AI-1 = PrepEx (Petra)
- **R-ANKI-** — **ANKI** · Anki vocabulary decks + app · see § 3 · e.g. R-ANKI-1 = 4000 Essential English Words
- **R-SHAD-** — **SHAD**owing · Shadowing source material · see § 4 · e.g. R-SHAD-1 = TED-Ed
- **R-FREE-** — **FREE** · Free practice test sources · see § 5 · e.g. R-FREE-1 = Magoosh free 2026 test
- **R-REAL-** — **REAL-world** · Real-world academic input · see § 6 · e.g. R-REAL-4 = MIT OpenCourseWare
- **R-REF-** — **REF**erence · Research papers / format guides · see § 7 · e.g. R-REF-1 = Liu 2014 ETS study

The trailing number is just the order within that category. So **R-SHAD-3** = the 3rd item in the Shadowing section (Scientific American 60-Second Science).

When a chapter says “Use R-OFF-1”: flip to § 1 of this file, find R-OFF-1, use the URL and instructions there.

1 · Official ETS Materials (gold standard for 2026 format)

R-OFF-1 — ETS TOEFL TestReady (official platform)

- **URL:** <https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>
- **Price:** Free tier + paid items
- **Use case:** Daily practice, official scoring, AI feedback. **Required.**

R-OFF-2 — ETS Sample Test Jan 2026 (FREE full sample)

- **URL:** <https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/sample-test-jan-2026-1.html>
- **Price:** Free
- **Use case:** **Use this for Day 2–3 baseline mock.** Exact new-format. Also reused as Mock 4 in Ch.9 (4 months later you’ll have forgotten enough).

R-OFF-3 — TOEFL iBT Test Content breakdown

- **URL:** <https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/about/content.html>
- **Price:** Free
- **Use case:** Reference for what every task looks like.

R-OFF-4 — TOEFL Test Prep Planner (8-week official plan, PDF)

- **URL:** <https://www.ets.org/pdfs/toefl/toefl-ibt-student-test-prep-planner.pdf>
- **Price:** Free PDF
- **Use case:** Cross-reference for the final stretch.

R-OFF-5 — TPO (TOEFL Practice Online) — OPTIONAL LAST-RESORT ONLY

- **URL:** <https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/practice-tests.html>
- **Price:** \$45.95 / volume
- **Use case:** **Skip unless** you’ve already done all 4 Ch.9 mocks from the free sources below AND you feel you need one more genuinely-official full-length retired test before exam day. The free sources in § 5 plus R-OFF-1’s free tier are designed to cover all 4 mocks at \$0.

2 · AI Feedback Tools (essential for Speaking/Writing)

R-AI-1 — PrepEx (Petra AI speaking coach)

- **URL:** <https://prepex.ai>
- **Price:** Freemium
- **Best for:** **Conversational** speaking practice → perfect for Interview task.

R-AI-2 — FluentPrep AI

- **URL:** <https://www.fluentprep.online/>
- **Price:** Freemium
- **Best for:** 4-section AI scoring using ETS rubrics; 900+ items.

R-AI-3 — TOEFLPrep.ai

- **URL:** <https://www.toeflprep.ai/>
- **Price:** Freemium
- **Best for:** New-format full mocks + AI feedback.

R-AI-4 — CogniCircuit AI

- **URL:** <https://www.cognicircuit.com/>
- **Price:** Freemium
- **Best for:** Real-time speaking + writing feedback.

R-AI-5 — ChatGPT (or Claude)

- **URL:** <https://chat.openai.com/> / <https://claude.ai>
- **Price:** Free tier (sufficient for this plan)
- **Best for:** Grammar polish + idea brainstorming. **Do not** trust its scores.

Rule of thumb: Pick **one** AI scorer (R-AI-1 or R-AI-2) and stick with it for trend tracking. Switching tools mid-plan ruins comparability. All five AI tools above have working free tiers — the plan is built on free tiers only.

3 · Anki Vocabulary Decks (spaced repetition)

R-ANKI-1 — 4000 Essential English Words (all 6 books)

- **URL:** <https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/1104981491>

- **Word count:** ~4000
- **Use case:** **Base deck.** Start with Book 4–6 (B2+ level).

R-ANKI-2 — Barron’s Essential Words for the TOEFL

- **URL:** <https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/973421516>
- **Word count:** ~500
- **Use case:** **TOEFL-specific.** Start Day 8.

R-ANKI-3 — Essential TOEFL Vocabulary 500

- **URL:** <https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/39885404>
- **Word count:** 500
- **Use case:** Backup/alternative to R-ANKI-2.

R-ANKI-4 — Anki desktop download

- **URL:** <https://apps.ankiweb.net/>
- **Price:** Free (desktop + Android via AnkiDroid)
- **Use case:** Required to import shared decks. Desktop (Mac/Windows/Linux) and Android (AnkiDroid) are 100% free. iOS users: use the web reviewer at <https://ankiweb.net> on Safari instead of the paid iOS app.

Daily Anki target (1.5 hr plan): 20 new + ~60 reviews ≈ 15 minutes.

4 · Shadowing Source Material (free, with transcripts)

Pick **one source per phase**; don’t rotate too fast.

R-SHAD-1 — TED-Ed

- **URL:** <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>
- **Length:** 4–6 min
- **Difficulty:** C1
- **Best for:** Phase 1 (Ch.1–3) — rich vocabulary, animated, has transcript.

R-SHAD-2 — TED Talks

- **URL:** <https://www.ted.com/talks>
- **Length:** 8–18 min
- **Difficulty:** B2–C1
- **Best for:** Phase 2 (Ch.4–6) — natural speech rhythm. **Filter by 5–10 min** length.

R-SHAD-3 — Scientific American 60-Second Science

- **URL:** <https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>
- **Length:** 60 sec
- **Difficulty:** C1
- **Best for:** Daily 1-minute focused shadow; great for Ch.4 Listen & Repeat training.

R-SHAD-4 — BBC 6 Minute English

- **URL:** <https://www.bbc.co.uk/learningenglish/english/features/6-minute-english>
- **Length:** 6 min
- **Difficulty:** B1–B2
- **Best for:** Easier warm-up; use when burnt out.

R-SHAD-5 — VOA Learning English

- **URL:** <https://learningenglish.voanews.com/>
- **Length:** 3–5 min
- **Difficulty:** A2–B2
- **Best for:** Slower pace; skip unless basics are weak.

R-SHAD-6 — Language Reactor (browser extension)

- **URL:** <https://www.languagereactor.com/>
- **Best for:** Slows YouTube/Netflix down, side-by-side transcripts. Game-changing for shadowing.

Shadowing 3-pass protocol (do this every session)

1. **Blind shadow** — no transcript, 1 pass.
2. **Transcript shadow** — read along while shadowing, 1 pass.
3. **Recorded shadow** — record yourself + compare to original, 1 pass.

Research (Hamada 2016): 10–15 min/day × 4–6 weeks → measurable gains in listening + fluency + pronunciation.

5 · Free Practice Test Sources (the Ch.9 mock backbone)

This plan uses free sources for every Ch.9 mock. Mix and match — using the same source for all 4 mocks may exhaust the free pool or train you on its quirks rather than the test.

R-FREE-1 — Magoosh free TOEFL practice test (2026 version)

- **URL:** <https://magoosh.com/toefl/toefl-practice-test/>
- **Format match:** High
- **Notes:** Free sign-up; full sections.

R-FREE-2 — BestMyTest free practice

- **URL:** <https://www.bestmytest.com/toefl/practice-test>
- **Format match:** Medium
- **Notes:** Quick drills.

R-FREE-3 — TestSucceed 2026 sample materials

- **URL:** https://testsucceed.com/materials/tests/toefl_new
- **Format match:** High
- **Notes:** Has examples for every new task type.

R-FREE-4 — ETS sample questions in TestReady free tier

- **URL:** (same as R-OFF-1)
- **Format match:** Highest
- **Notes:** Use first before any third-party.

R-FREE-5 — TOEFLResources.com 2026 templates & samples

- **URL:** <https://www.toeflresources.com/>
- **Format match:** High
- **Notes:** Good for Speaking/Writing **structure ideas** (do **not** memorize templates).

6 · Real-World Academic Input (the “general English exposure” multiplier)

ETS research (Liu 2014) found coaching attendance has **near-zero** correlation with score improvement. Total real-English exposure does. Build a weekly diet of:

R-REAL-1 — The Economist (Espresso free daily)

- **URL:** <https://www.economist.com/the-world-in-brief>
- **Use:** 5-minute daily read; complex prose.

R-REAL-2 — The Atlantic

- **URL:** <https://www.theatlantic.com>
- **Use:** Long-form, similar register to TOEFL Reading.

R-REAL-3 — Nature News / Science News

- **URLs:** <https://www.nature.com/news> · <https://www.sciencenews.org>
- **Use:** Scientific writing = TOEFL Reading clone.

R-REAL-4 — MIT OpenCourseWare lecture audio

- **URL:** <https://ocw.mit.edu/>
- **Use:** **Best free lecture audio** that mirrors TOEFL Listening lectures.

R-REAL-5 — Coursera free audit (any English-taught course)

- **URL:** <https://www.coursera.org/>
- **Use:** Long-form lectures + readings.

R-REAL-6 — NPR Up First / Hidden Brain podcasts

- **URL:** <https://www.npr.org/podcasts/>
- **Use:** Conversational listening.

R-REAL-7 — Khan Academy SAT Reading practice

- **URL:** <https://www.khanacademy.org/test-prep/sat>
- **Use:** Free academic reading drills, B2–C1.

7 · Reference / Research

R-REF-1 — ETS Research: Test Preparation effectiveness (Liu 2014)

- **URL:** <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/full/10.1002/ets2.12016>

R-REF-2 — Hamada (2016) Shadowing research review

- **URL:** <https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/abs/10.1177/1362168815597504>

R-REF-3 — ETS 2026 TOEFL announcement & changes

- **URL:** <https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/about/test-changes.html>

R-REF-4 — Beyond English 2026 guide

- **URL:** <https://beyondenglish.com/the-2026-toefl-ibt-a-complete-guide-to-the-new-format-scoring-and-strategy/>

R-REF-5 — Magoosh 2026 changes

- **URL:** <https://toefl.magoosh.com/toefl-2026-changes>

R-REF-6 — My Speaking Score 2026 Speaking guide (free article)

- **URL:** <https://www.myspeakingscore.com/toefl-speaking-2026>
 - **Note:** Free read-only guide. Their scoring product is paid and not used in this plan.
-

8 · Setup Checklist (Day 1 — do all of this)

- ☐ Create account on **R-OFF-1** (ETS TestReady)
- ☐ Bookmark **R-OFF-2** for tomorrow's mock
- ☐ Install Anki desktop (**R-ANKI-4**), import **R-ANKI-1** (start from Book 4)
- ☐ Create account on **R-AI-1** (PrepEx) — or **R-AI-2** if you prefer rubric scoring over conversation
- ☐ Subscribe to **R-SHAD-3** (60-Second Science) in your podcast app
- ☐ Bookmark **R-SHAD-1** (TED-Ed) — pick 1 video for Day 4's first shadow
- ☐ Decide where your **error log** lives (Notion page, markdown file, Apple Notes — pick one and don't switch)
- ☐ Optional: install **R-SHAD-6** (Language Reactor) browser extension

Total spend: \$0 — full plan, all 130 days, all 4 mocks. Every required resource has a working free tier or is fully free. The only paid resource still listed (R-OFF-5 TPO) is flagged **optional last-resort** — skip it unless you've already burned through all the free Ch.9 mocks and want one extra rep before exam day.

Ch.1 · Diagnosis & System Setup (5/18 – 5/31)

Days: 14 (Day 1 = Mon 5/18, Day 14 = Sun 5/31) **Theme:** Get tools installed, get a baseline, lock in habits **Skill coverage:** Every day touches ≥ 2 skills (Anki + Shadowing automatically cover vocab + L+S) **Deliverables:** 4-skill baseline scores + weak-skill profile + 90-min daily flow operational

1 · Chapter goals (self-assess Day 14)

- **G1 — Tools live:** TestReady, Anki, Shadowing source, AI tool — all logged in
 - **G2 — 4-skill baselines collected:** one scored attempt for R / L / S / W
 - **G3 — Weak-skill profile:** can name in 3 sentences which skill is weakest, why, and what the first move is
 - **G4 — Anki running:** decks imported, 7-day streak unbroken
 - **G5 — Shadowing running:** ≥ 6 sessions done, mouth muscle memory starting to shift
 - **G6 — Error log started:** ≥ 5 entries, each with “why I got it wrong”
-

2 · This chapter’s modified weekly plan

Ch.1 is the “setup chapter.” Days 1–3 are **special** (install + baseline). Standard weekly rotation (README § 2.2) kicks in from Day 4.

Week 1 (5/18 – 5/24): Setup + diagnosis + ignition

- **Day 1 · Mon 5/18** — Tool install + read 2026 format spec · skills touched: R
- **Day 2 · Tue 5/19** — **Baseline mock: Reading + Listening** (90 min) · skills: R, L
- **Day 3 · Wed 5/20** — **Baseline mock: Speaking + Writing** (90 min) · skills: S, W
- **Day 4 · Thu 5/21** — Scoring + weak-skill profile + Anki ignition · skills: L, S (via Anki + Shadowing)
- **Day 5 · Fri 5/22** — Standard day: S MAIN / L SECONDARY · skills: S, L
- **Day 6 · Sat 5/23** — Standard day: R MAIN / S SECONDARY · skills: R, S
- **Day 7 · Sun 5/24** — Standard day: L+S combined / W SECONDARY · skills: L, S, W

Week 2 (5/25 – 5/31): Full rotation + bi-week review

- **Day 8 · Mon 5/25** — MAIN = Writing (Email first attempt) · SECONDARY = Short mock + review
- **Day 9 · Tue 5/26** — MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Writing
- **Day 10 · Wed 5/27** — MAIN = Listening · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Day 11 · Thu 5/28** — MAIN = Writing · SECONDARY = Reading
- **Day 12 · Fri 5/29** — MAIN = Speaking · SECONDARY = Listening
- **Day 13 · Sat 5/30** — MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Speaking

- **Day 14 · Sun 5/31 — MAIN = L+S combined + bi-week review · SECONDARY = Writing**

Week 2 touches (MAIN+SEC, with the L+S combined day counting once for each): R×3, L×3, W×4, S×4. Plus daily Anki + Shadowing → **all 4 skills hit ≥ 3 times in the week.**

3 · Daily checklists (14 days)

Default: 90 min/day. If a weekday is tight, drop the 20-min “real material” block; everything else holds. **Anki + Shadowing = floor.** Never skipped. Resource codes (e.g. **R-OFF-2**) point to `resources.md`.

Day 1 · Mon 5/18 — Tool install day

Today’s focus: Stand up every tool you’ll touch for the next 130 days so nothing blocks tomorrow’s mock.

Goal: Every tool installed and openable

- ☐ **0:00–0:20** Create account at **R-OFF-1** (ETS TestReady — <https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>). Take the 5-question survey to generate your free study plan.
- ☐ **0:20–0:35** Install Anki desktop (**R-ANKI-4** — <https://apps.ankiweb.net/>). Import “4000 Essential English Words” deck (**R-ANKI-1** — <https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/1104981491>). In Deck Options, set **New cards/day = 20, Maximum reviews/day = 100**.
- ☐ **0:35–0:50** Create account on **R-AI-1** (PrepEx — <https://prepex.ai>) or **R-AI-2** (FluentPrep — <https://www.fluentprep.online/>). Pick one and stick with it for the next 130 days.
- ☐ **0:50–1:10** Bookmark in your browser: **R-OFF-2** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/sample-test-jan-2026-1.html> — tomorrow’s mock) + **R-SHAD-1** (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons> — TED-Ed library).

- ☐ **1:10–1:30** Read the ETS 2026 format spec — **R-OFF-3** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/about/content.html>). Read at least the **Reading** and **Speaking** sections in full so you know tomorrow’s mock structure.

Error log: No items today. Instead, write one **prediction**: which of the 4 skills do you expect to be your weakest? Why? (You’ll compare against the actual baseline in Day 4.)

Day 2 · Tue 5/19 — Baseline mock R+L

Today’s focus: Capture an honest “naked” Reading + Listening score before any prep contaminates the data.

Goal: Get scored on Reading + Listening, full new-format conditions

 Today breaks the 90-min template. **Run the mock end-to-end** — no phone, no pauses.

- ☐ **0:00–0:45** Open **R-OFF-2** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/sample-test-jan-2026-1.html> → “Take the Reading section”). Complete the **full Reading section** (both Modules). Strict timing.
- ☐ **0:45–1:30** Without leaving the page, do the **full Listening section** (both Modules). Max 5 min break in between.
- ☐ **Evening +15 min** (optional): Score with the answer key, log raw counts and wrong-item IDs into your error log. **Don’t analyze why yet** — that’s Day 4.

Baseline table (write this in your error log):

Day 2 (5/19) Baseline — Source: ETS Jan 2026 Sample Test

- Reading: __ / __	Module 1: __ / __	Module 2: __ / __
- Listening: __ / __	Module 1: __ / __	Module 2: __ / __
- Wrong items: R []	L []	

Day 3 · Wed 5/20 — Baseline mock S+W

Today's focus: Complete the 4-skill baseline by capturing scored Speaking + Writing samples under exam conditions.

Goal: Get scored on Speaking + Writing

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Open **R-OFF-2** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/sample-test-jan-2026-1.html>) → Speaking section → **Task 1 “Listen and Repeat”** (7 items). Listen once, repeat into your phone's Voice Memos. **Do not look at transcript.** Save as D3_Speaking_Repeat.
- ☐ **0:15–0:45** Same site → **Task 2 “Take an Interview”** (4 items, 45 sec each). **No prep time** — listen, then go. Record each one as D3_Speaking_Interview_1 through _4.
- ☐ **0:45–1:00** Open Writing section → do **Build a Sentence** items + the **Email** task (~100 words, strict 10 min). Save the Email text to your error log under D3_Writing_Email.
- ☐ **1:00–1:30** Same site → **Academic Discussion** task (200 words, 10 min). Save text as D3_Writing_Discussion.
- ☐ **Evening +15 min:** Upload Speaking recordings to **R-AI-1** (<https://prepex.ai>) or **R-AI-2** (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>) for AI scoring. Paste both Writing tasks into the same AI tool for rubric-based scoring. Log all four scores into the baseline table below.

Baseline table (append to error log):

Day 3 (5/20) Baseline

- Speaking Repeat: ___ / 7 (count "fully matched" repeats)
 - Speaking Interview: AI score ___ (Delivery ___ / Language ___ / Topic ___)
 - Writing Email: AI score ___ (Words: ___ Time: ___ min)
 - Writing Discussion: AI score ___ (Words: ___ Time: ___ min)
 - Hardest skill (gut feel): _____
-

Day 4 · Thu 5/21 — Weak-skill profile + Anki ignition

Today's focus: Convert Day 2–3 raw scores into a written weak-skill profile and ignite the two daily-floor habits (Anki + Shadowing).

Goal: Turn yesterday's numbers into your 4-month script

- ☐ **0:00–0:15 First real Anki session:** 20 new + reviews. From **R-ANKI-1** (<https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/1104981491>), start with **Book 4** (B2 level — skip Books 1–3 unless you struggled with the baseline reading).
- ☐ **0:15–0:30 First Shadowing session.** Pick **one** TED-Ed video from **R-SHAD-1** (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>) — recommend “How Do You Decide Where to Go in a Self-Driving Car?” or anything 4–5 min with science vocab. Record pass 3 into Voice Memos as D4_Shadow (you'll re-listen on Day 14). Run the **3-pass protocol**:
 1. Blind shadow (no transcript) — 1 pass
 2. Transcript shadow (read along while shadowing) — 1 pass
 3. Record-and-compare — 1 pass
- ☐ **0:30–1:00 Build your weak-skill profile** (the core task today). Open your error log and fill this in:

Weak-Skill Profile (5/21)

Section scores (estimate against 0–120)

- Reading: __/30 → CEFR __
- Listening: __/30 → CEFR __
- Speaking: __/30 → CEFR __
- Writing: __/30 → CEFR __
- Total: __/120

Weakest skill: _____

- Wrong-item patterns: _____ (e.g., inference questions, vocab-in-context, gist)
- My guess at why: _____ (e.g., vocabulary too small, can't catch connected speech)

Second-weakest skill: _____

- Wrong-item patterns: _____
- My guess at why: _____

Priority target by end of Ch.1: _____

- ☐ **1:00–1:20 Real material:** read one *Scientific American 60-Second Science* transcript (**R-SHAD-3** — <https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>), then listen twice.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Error log:** from Day 2's wrong items, pick 3 and write "why I got it wrong" (one line each).
-

 Day 5 · Fri 5/22 — Standard day (S MAIN / L SECONDARY)

Today's focus: First standard rotation day — push Speaking with Listen & Repeat reps and warm Listening with a Conversation set.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15 Anki (R-ANKI-1** — <https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/1104981491>): 20 new + reviews
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30 Shadowing:** new TED-Ed video from **R-SHAD-1** (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>) at **1.0×** speed first; run the 3-pass protocol
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Speaking MAIN** — Listen & Repeat drill. Use **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → log in → Speaking → Task 1. 7 items. After each: record into Voice Memos → self-rate (linking / stress / intonation) → re-record. If TestReady free tier is exhausted, fall back to **R-FREE-3** (https://testsucceed.com/materials/tests/toefl_new) sample items.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Listening SECONDARY** — **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Listening → one Conversation set (5 items). Aim for $\geq 4/5$ on first try; log misses in error log.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Error log** (3 lines — one item per wrong answer with "why I got it wrong")
-

 Day 6 · Sat 5/23 — Standard day (R MAIN / S SECONDARY)

Today's focus: Train Module-1 Reading pace under strict timing; keep Speaking warm with 2 Interview reps.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki: 20 new + reviews
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing: TED-Ed (**R-SHAD-1** — <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>), 3-pass protocol
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → one passage (Module 1 set). **Strict 15 min timer.** Goal: ≥ 80% Module 1 accuracy. Log score + wrong-item IDs.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY** — Open **R-AI-1** (<https://prepex.ai>) → Interview practice → 2 questions (45 sec each). Topics to ask Petra for: one “state an opinion” + one “recall a memory.” Save Petra’s score in error log.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log (3 lines)
-

Day 7 · Sun 5/24 — L+S combined / W secondary

Today’s focus: First combined L+S drill (the format that mirrors real-test integrated tasks); plus close the week with a Writing rep and mini-review.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki: 20 new + reviews
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing: 3-pass protocol on a **R-SHAD-1** (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>) TED-Ed video
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Listening + Speaking combined drill:** Pick a 5–8 min TED talk from **R-SHAD-2** (<https://www.ted.com/talks>, filter by 5–10 min). Listen once → record a 60-sec spoken summary into Voice Memos as D7_LS_Summary → listen again to verify accuracy (note any factual misses in error log).
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY** — Open **R-FREE-3** (https://testsucceed.com/materials/tests/toefl_new) → Build a Sentence samples (5 items) + write 1 Email (100 words, 10 min). Paste Email into **R-AI-5** (<https://chat.openai.com> or <https://claude.ai>) → ask for grammar polish only (no scoring — see Rule of Thumb in resources.md § 2).
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Weekly mini-review** (not the bi-week review): in the error log, write 2 lines — which day was hardest to keep? Why?
-

Day 8 · Mon 5/25 — Writing Email first attempt

Today's focus: First scored Writing Email of the week-2 rotation, plus add the TOEFL-specific vocab deck to Anki.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — import **R-ANKI-2** (Barron's TOEFL — <https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/973421516>) into your Anki desktop and start it. Today: 10 new from Barron's + 10 new from **R-ANKI-1** (<https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/1104981491>) = 20 new total.
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing: 3-pass protocol on a **R-SHAD-1** (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>) TED-Ed video
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Writing MAIN** — Write 1 full Email under exam conditions. Prompt source: **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Writing → Email task, OR **R-FREE-3** (https://testsucceed.com/materials/tests/toefl_new) → Email samples. **Strict 10 min timer.** Submit to **R-AI-1** (<https://prepex.ai>) or **R-AI-2** (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>) for rubric scoring; log the 3 sub-scores.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Short mock** — **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → 1 passage Module 1 (5 items). Focus on accuracy not speed; aim $\geq 4/5$.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log (3 lines)
-

Day 9 · Tue 5/26 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

Today's focus: Add the “why wrong” attribution discipline (knowledge gap / careless / time) so Ch.2 has clean diagnostic data.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki: 10 Barron's + 10 4000EEW
- ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing: 3-pass protocol on a **R-SHAD-1** (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>) video
- ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN** — **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → 1 passage (strict 15 min). After scoring, **attribute each wrong item** in the error log with one tag: knowledge gap / careless / time. Don't just look at the answer.

- ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY** — Build a Sentence × 5 items via **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Writing section practice.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Error log** (3 lines)
-

Day 10 · Wed 5/27 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Double-dose Listening (lecture + conversation) to stress-test the format range; Speaking stays warm via Interview.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15 Anki:** 10 Barron's + 10 4000EEW
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30 Shadowing:** 3-pass protocol on a **R-SHAD-1** (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>) video
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Listening MAIN — R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Listening → 1 lecture set (6 items) + 1 conversation set (5 items). Log both raw scores.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY — R-AI-1** (<https://prepex.ai>) → Petra Interview → 2 questions on different styles: one **opinion**, one **describe your lifestyle**. Save Petra's scores.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Error log** (3 lines, attribute each: knowledge gap / careless / time)
-

Day 11 · Thu 5/28 — W MAIN / R SECONDARY

Today's focus: First Academic Discussion under exam timing; expose your eyes to real-world academic prose for the secondary block.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15 Anki:** 10 Barron's + 10 4000EEW
- ☐ **0:15–0:30 Shadowing:** 3-pass protocol on a **R-SHAD-1** (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>) video
- ☐ **0:30–1:00 Writing MAIN** — Academic Discussion, 1 prompt (200 words, **strict 10 min timer**). Prompt source: **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) or **R-FREE-3** (https://testsucceed.com/materials/tests/toefl_new). Score via **R-AI-2** (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>) → check **Topic Development** sub-score specifically and log it.

- ☐ **1:00–1:20 Reading SECONDARY** — One *Science News* article (**R-REAL-3** — <https://www.sciencenews.org>) + one *Economist Espresso* daily (**R-REAL-1** — <https://www.economist.com/the-world-in-brief>). Read for comprehension, not items; jot 1 unfamiliar word from each into Anki as a custom card.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Error log** (3 lines)
-

Day 12 · Fri 5/29 — S MAIN / L SECONDARY

Today's focus: Mixed Speaking drill (both 2026 task types in one session); introduce handwritten note-taking on Listening to mimic exam conditions.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15 Anki:** 10 Barron's + 10 4000EEW
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30 Shadowing:** 3-pass protocol on a **R-SHAD-1** (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>) video
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Speaking MAIN** — Mixed drill: Listen & Repeat × 7 + Interview × 2. Use **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Speaking section — if exhausted, switch to **R-AI-1** (<https://prepex.ai>) Petra Interview mode. Record everything into Voice Memos as D12_Speaking_.*.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Listening SECONDARY — R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → 1 lecture set; this time take **handwritten notes** on real scratch paper during the lecture (mimics real test conditions). Score after, log accuracy delta vs. Day 10 listening.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Error log** (3 lines)
-

Day 13 · Sat 5/30 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Last working day before bi-week review — hit Reading speed + the new Complete-the-Words sub-task, plus Speaking warmth.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15 Anki:** 10 Barron's + 10 4000EEW
- ☐ **0:15–0:30 Shadowing:** 3-pass protocol on a **R-SHAD-1** (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>) video

- ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → 1 passage (strict 15 min) **plus** one **Complete the Words** drill (**R-OFF-1** Reading section has this as a sub-task type — practice 1 paragraph with 10 missing-letter words). Log both raw scores.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY — R-AI-1** (<https://prepex.ai>) → Petra Interview × 2 questions. Save scores.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Error log** (3 lines)
-

Day 14 · Sun 5/31 — 🎯 Bi-week review day

Today's focus: Audit the 14-day setup phase, hear measurable shadowing progress, and write modification orders for Ch.2.

Today is different. Use the full 90 min on review, not new items.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15 Anki + reviews** (floor — never skip)
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30 Shadowing** — re-open the **R-SHAD-1** (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>) Day 4 video. Re-record pass 3 as D14_Shadow and A/B compare against the D4_Shadow Voice Memo. Note the difference in 1 line in your error log.
 - ☐ **0:30–1:30 Bi-week review** — complete the **Ch.1 Review Card** in § 4 below. Fill every field; decide whether Ch.2 needs adjustments per the “Modification orders” section.
-

4 · Ch.1 Review Card (fill out on Day 14)

Ch.1 Review (5/31)

Goals self-check

- [] G1 Tools all live
- [] G2 Baselines collected (R:___ L:___ S:___ W:___)
- [] G3 Weak-skill profile clear
- [] G4 Anki — 14-day streak unbroken
- [] G5 Shadowing ≥ 6 sessions done
- [] G6 Error log ≥ 5 entries with "why" attribution

Three numbers

- Anki cumulative cards learned: ____
- Shadowing sessions completed: ____
- Error log entries: ____

Three answers

1. Biggest discovery about my own English ability?
→
2. Which area lags the plan? Why?
→
3. What does Ch.2 (Listening + vocabulary focus) need to adjust?
→

"Modification orders" for Ch.2

- If Day 2 Listening < __/30 → Ch.2 bumps Listening MAIN from 2× to 4× per week
 - If Anki is hard to keep → drop new cards from 20 → 15, ****but never stop****
 - If Shadowing feels useless → switch to ****sentence-level intensive shadowing**** (one sentence, 5 reps each) for Ch.2
-

5 · Common pitfalls in this chapter

1. **Don't read strategy tips before the baseline mock.** You want “naked score now,” not “score when prepared.”
2. **One Anki deck at a time.** Import 4000EEW first; add Barron's only on Day 8 once the habit holds.
3. **Shadowing week 1 feels terrible — that's normal.** Research shows real gains at 4–6 weeks. Don't quit at day 5.
4. **AI speaking scores are not truth.** They're reliable on delivery/fluency, weaker on topic development. Track the trend, not the absolute number.
5. **Don't wait to “be ready” to write the error log.** Write it tonight — 3 lines beats 0 lines by infinity.

Ch.2 · Listening Foundation + High-Frequency Vocabulary (6/1 – 6/14)

Days: 14 (Day 1 = Mon 6/1, Day 14 = Sun 6/14) **Emphasis:** Listening (on top of standard rotation). Vocabulary cadence raised. **Skill coverage:** Every

day touches ≥ 2 skills. Daily Anki = vocab floor. Daily Shadowing = L+S floor. **Deliverables:** Listening Module 1 $\geq 80\%$ on single pass + 200 new high-frequency words mastered + a note-taking system you trust.

1 · Chapter goals (self-assess Day 14)

- **G1 — Listening Module 1 accuracy:** $\geq 80\%$ on a fresh **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) Listening set
 - **G2 — Note-taking system:** one system (T-chart or Cornell) used consistently in 6+ practice lectures
 - **G3 — Vocab cadence:** Anki streak intact; 200+ new cards learned in chapter; mature card retention $\geq 85\%$
 - **G4 — Conversation vs Lecture:** can score $\geq 4/5$ on conversations AND $\geq 5/6$ on lectures (single attempt, fresh material)
 - **G5 — Shadowing focused on lectures:** ≥ 10 lecture-style shadowing sessions completed
 - **G6 — Error log discipline:** every listening error tagged with cause — vocab / speed / inattention / accent
-

2 · Modified weekly plan (Listening emphasis)

Standard rotation per README § 2.2 still applies. **Three changes for this chapter:**

1. **Shadowing source switches** from TED-Ed to lecture-style material — **R-REAL-4** MIT OpenCourseWare lecture audio (<https://ocw.mit.edu/>) or longer TED talks (**R-SHAD-2** TED Talks (<https://www.ted.com/talks>), filter ≥ 10 min). Lecture register matches the test's Listening section.
2. **The Sunday MAIN slot** changes from Writing → **Listening micro-mock** (8-item Listening set in ~12 min).
3. **Anki pace:** still 20 new/day, but cards introduced from **R-ANKI-2** Barron's Essential Words for the TOEFL (<https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/973421516>) are prioritized this chapter for academic listening vocab.

Week-1 and Week-2 cadence (identical)

- **Sunday · MAIN = Listening micro-mock** (8 items) · **SECONDARY = Writing** — 1 Email or Build-a-Sentence drill

- **Monday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Writing
- **Tuesday** · MAIN = **Listening** (lecture + conversation) · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Wednesday** · MAIN = Writing · SECONDARY = Reading
- **Thursday** · MAIN = Speaking · SECONDARY = **Listening** (lecture, with notes)
- **Friday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Saturday** · MAIN = **Listening + Speaking combined** · SECONDARY = Writing

Weekly skill counts (MAIN/SECONDARY/combined): - L: 2 MAIN + 1 SEC + 1 combined = 4 focused touches - R: 2 MAIN + 1 SEC = 3 - W: 1 MAIN + 2 SEC = 3 - S: 1 MAIN + 2 SEC + 1 combined = 4

All four skills hit ≥ 3 focused sessions per week. 

3 · Daily checklists (14 days)

Resource codes (e.g. **R-OFF-1**) → see `resources.md`.

Day 1 · Mon 6/1 — Listening micro-mock + Email warm-up

Today's focus: Kick off the chapter by establishing a baseline Listening micro-mock score and locking in the new lecture-style shadowing source.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — 20 new (10 from **R-ANKI-2** Barron's Essential Words for the TOEFL (<https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/973421516>) + 10 from **R-ANKI-1** 4000 Essential English Words (<https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/1104981491>) Book 5) + reviews. Log finished count in error log.
- ☐ **0:15–0:30 Shadowing** — switch source: open **R-REAL-4** MIT OpenCourseWare (<https://ocw.mit.edu/>) → pick any intro lecture, grab a 5-min excerpt **or** **R-SHAD-2** TED Talks (<https://www.ted.com/talks>) filtered 10–18 min. Run 3-pass protocol; save the recording as D1_Shadow.
- ☐ **0:30–1:00 Listening micro-mock (8 items)** — **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → log in → Listening → 1 lecture set (6 items) + first 2 items of 1 conversation set. Score immediately; write D1 L: ___/8 in error log.

- ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY** — Email task: **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Writing → Email. 10 min strict. Paste into **R-AI-2** FluentPrep AI (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>) for rubric scoring; log overall band.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log (3 lines) — one line each for L, W, vocab takeaway.
-

Day 2 · Tue 6/2 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

Today's focus: Anchor Reading pace at 15 min/passage and use Build-a-Sentence reps to drill sentence-level grammar control.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — 20 new + due reviews.
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing — fresh MIT lecture clip from **R-REAL-4** MIT OpenCourseWare (<https://ocw.mit.edu/>), 3-pass protocol; save recording as D2_Shadow.
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → 1 fresh passage. Strict 15 min timer. Score immediately; tag wrong-answer cause (vocab / inference / detail).
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY — R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Writing → Build a Sentence × 5 items. Log accuracy D2 BaS: __/5.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

Day 3 · Wed 6/3 — L MAIN (lecture + conversation) / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: First full L MAIN day — adopt the T-chart note system and begin tagging every L miss by cause.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — 20 new + reviews.
- ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing — lecture clip (MIT or TED), 3-pass; save as D3_Shadow.
- ☐ **0:30–1:00 Listening MAIN — R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Listening → 1 full lecture set (6 items) + 1 conversation set (5 items). **Use the note-taking system**

you're testing this chapter (start with T-chart: left = main idea, right = examples/details). Save the notes page in your error log.

- ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY – R-AI-1** PrepEx / Petra (<https://prepex.ai>) → Interview × 2 questions. Save AI feedback screenshots.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log – for each L wrong answer, tag cause: **vocab / speed / inattention / accent**.
-

Day 4 · Thu 6/4 – W MAIN / R SECONDARY

Today's focus: First Academic Discussion attempt of the chapter; feed unknown science vocab from Nature back into Anki.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + reviews) + Shadowing (3-pass lecture clip, save as D4_Shadow).
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Writing MAIN – Academic Discussion 1** prompt (200 words, 10 min). Source: **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Writing → Academic Discussion. Score via **R-AI-2** FluentPrep AI (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>); log band.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Reading SECONDARY – 1** article from **R-REAL-3** Nature News (<https://www.nature.com/news>). Read for comprehension; note 5 unknown words → add to Anki as a custom note tonight.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

Day 5 · Fri 6/5 – S MAIN / L SECONDARY (lecture, notes-focused)

Today's focus: First Listen & Repeat speaking reps; produce a clean reference set of lecture notes you'll re-compare on Day 12.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + reviews) + Shadowing (3-pass, save as D5_Shadow).
- ☐ **0:30–1:00 Speaking MAIN – Listen & Repeat × 7** from **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Speaking → Listen & Repeat (or **R-FREE-3** TestSucceed sample set (https://testsucceed.com/materials/tests/toefl_new)). Record each into phone Voice Memos, save as D5_LR_1..7, self-score for matched syllables.

- ☐ **1:00–1:20 Listening SECONDARY — R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Listening → 1 lecture only. Goal today: pure note-taking practice. Score after, but the real product is your **notes** — paste them into the error log under D5_LectureNotes.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

Day 6 · Sat 6/6 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Explore the Reading Complete-the-Words sub-task while broadening Petra prompts beyond opinion-only.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + reviews) + Shadowing (3-pass, save as D6_Shadow).
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → 1 passage. Today also try **Complete the Words** sub-task (10 missing-letter paragraph) if not done before; log D6 CtW: __/10.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY — R-AI-1** PrepEx / Petra (<https://prepex.ai>) → Interview × 2 (one **opinion** + one **memory**). Save AI feedback.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

Day 7 · Sun 6/7 — L+S combined / W secondary

Today's focus: Week-1 capstone — fuse listening notes into a spoken summary, then surface the dominant L error pattern.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + reviews) + Shadowing (3-pass, save as D7_Shadow).
- ☐ **0:30–1:00 Listening + Speaking combined** — Pick a 10–15 min lecture from **R-SHAD-2** TED Talks (<https://www.ted.com/talks>) OR **R-REAL-4** MIT OpenCourseWare (<https://ocw.mit.edu/>). Listen once (notes only). Then **without re-listening**, record a 90-sec spoken summary including: main thesis + 2 supporting points (save as D7_Summary). Re-listen → score yourself on coverage and accuracy.

- ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY** — 1 Email (10 min) from **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Writing → Email.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Weekly mini-review: tally all L error cause tags from Days 1–7 and log the *single most common* one at the top of the error log for Week 2 targeting.
-

Day 8 · Mon 6/8 — Listening micro-mock + Email

Today's focus: Mid-chapter Listening pulse-check — compare against the Day 1 baseline to confirm the curve is moving.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + reviews) + Shadowing (3-pass, save as D8_Shadow).
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Listening micro-mock (8 items)** — fresh set from **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Listening (1 lecture + 2 conv items). Score immediately; log D8 L: ___/8 next to D1 L: ___/8 for delta comparison.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY** — 1 Email, 10 min from **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Writing → Email. Score via **R-AI-2** FluentPrep AI (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>).
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

Day 9 · Tue 6/9 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

Today's focus: Tighten Reading attribution discipline and step up Build-a-Sentence volume from 5 to 8 items.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + reviews) + Shadowing (3-pass, save as D9_Shadow).
- ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → 1 passage, strict 15 min. **Attribute** every wrong answer (vocab / inference / detail / paraphrase) in the error log.

- ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY – R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Writing → Build a Sentence × 8 items. Log D9 BaS: __/8.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

Day 10 · Wed 6/10 – L MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Push into harder Listening material to stress-test the note system before the Day 14 showcase.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + reviews) + Shadowing (3-pass, save as D10_Shadow).
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Listening MAIN – R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Listening → 1 lecture (6) + 1 conversation (5). Today: pick the **harder** module if TestReady offers a choice. Log D10 L: __/11 and cause-tag every miss.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY – R-AI-1** PrepEx / Petra (<https://prepex.ai>) → Interview × 2 questions.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

Day 11 · Thu 6/11 – W MAIN / R SECONDARY

Today's focus: Diagnose Writing Topic Development weakness and expose yourself to long-form prose at TOEFL register.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + reviews) + Shadowing (3-pass, save as D11_Shadow).
- ☐ **0:30–1:00 Writing MAIN – R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Writing → Academic Discussion, 10 min strict. AI-score via **R-AI-2** FluentPrep AI (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>), **specifically check Topic Development** sub-score; log it separately.
- ☐ **1:00–1:20 Reading SECONDARY – 1** long-form article from **R-REAL-2** The Atlantic (<https://www.theatlantic.com>). 15-min read, no scoring. Note 3 unknown words for tomorrow's Anki adds.
- ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log

 Day 12 · Fri 6/12 — S MAIN / L SECONDARY

Today's focus: Mixed-format Speaking volume day; benchmark note-taking growth against Day 5.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + reviews) + Shadowing (3-pass, save as D12_Shadow).
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Speaking MAIN** — Listen & Repeat × 7 from **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Speaking → Listen & Repeat + Interview × 2 via **R-AI-1** PrepEx / Petra (<https://prepex.ai>). Record all (D12_LR_*, D12_Int_*).
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Listening SECONDARY** — **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Listening → 1 lecture (6 items). **Compare today's note quality to Day 5** — paste D12_LectureNotes next to D5_LectureNotes in error log.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

 Day 13 · Sat 6/13 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Final pre-showcase Reading rep and a light Speaking session — keep tomorrow's energy reserved for the mock.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + reviews) + Shadowing (3-pass, save as D13_Shadow).
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN** — **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → 1 fresh passage, strict 15 min. Cause-tag every miss.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY** — **R-AI-1** PrepEx / Petra (<https://prepex.ai>) → Interview × 2.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log
-

17 Day 14 · Sun 6/14 — Bi-week review + Listening showcase mock

Today's focus: Showcase mock decides G1; review card converts the chapter's data into modification orders for Ch.3.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — 20 new + due reviews; note cumulative new card count for G3.
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing — re-run the Day 1 clip (D1_Shadow source); record as D14_Shadow_redo and compare fluency/accuracy side-by-side.
 - ☐ **0:30–1:10 Showcase Listening mock** — full Listening Section (2 modules) from **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Listening. Strict timing, single pass, no replays. Log Module 1 % for G1.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Bi-week review** — fill the Ch.2 Review Card below.
-

4 · Ch.2 Review Card (fill Day 14)

Ch.2 Review (6/14)

Goals self-check

- [] G1 Listening Module 1 $\geq$ 80% on showcase mock (Day 14) → actual: __/__
- [] G2 One note system used 6+ times
- [] G3 Anki streak intact; cumulative new cards: ____
- [] G4 Conversation $\geq$ 4/5 and Lecture $\geq$ 5/6 hit at least once
- [] G5 $\geq$ 10 lecture shadows done
- [] G6 Listening errors all cause-tagged

Pattern data

- Most common L error cause tag: _____
- Most common L topic missed: _____ (e.g., biology / art history / economics)
- Conversation vs Lecture: which is harder? _____

Modification orders for Ch.3 (Reading emphasis)

- If L still below 80% on Day-14 mock → Ch.3 holds L MAIN at 2 sessions/week (don't drop to 1)
- If vocabulary tag is dominant → Ch.3 doubles down on ****R-ANKI-2**** Barron's Essential Words for the TOEFL (<https://ankiweb.net/shared/>

[info/973421516](https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/973421516))

- If accent/speed tag dominant → Ch.3 Shadowing moves to 1.25× speed

5 · Common pitfalls in this chapter

1. **Don't replay a listening clip mid-attempt.** The test gives one pass — your practice must too.
2. **Notes aren't a transcript.** Capture structure (intro / 3 points / conclusion), not every word. Compare your notes to ETS's lecture outline (where provided) on Day 5 & 12.
3. **Anki fatigue is real.** If reviews stack above 100, **don't add new cards** until you're under 50 backlog. Better to skip new than drop reviews.
4. **Lecture vocab ≠ conversation vocab.** Lectures use formal academic register (e.g., *substantiate*, *predominantly*, *intricate*) — Barron's TOEFL deck (**R-ANKI-2** <https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/973421516>) is tuned for this.
5. **Speed isn't the problem early on.** Most missed listening items come from a single unknown word or distraction, not pace. Identify the cause before “trying to listen faster.”

Ch.3 · Reading Foundation + Academic Vocabulary (6/15 – 6/28)

Days: 14 (Day 1 = Mon 6/15, Day 14 = Sun 6/28) **Emphasis:** Reading (on top of standard rotation). Academic vocabulary deepens. **Skill coverage:** Every day touches ≥ 2 skills. Anki + Shadowing remain floor. **Deliverables:** **Reading Module 1 accuracy ≥ 85%** (this is **Milestone 1** from README § 4) + Complete-the-Words sub-task fluency + AWL (Academic Word List) top-200 absorbed.

1 · Chapter goals (self-assess Day 14)

- **G1 — Reading Module 1 ≥ 85%:** fresh **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) Reading Module 1 set, single attempt
- **G2 — Passage pacing:** one academic passage + 10 items in ≤ 15 min, comfortably
- **G3 — Complete the Words:** ≥ 8/10 on missing-letter task in one attempt

- **G4 — Academic vocab:** 200 new Barron's/AWL cards mature in Anki (interval ≥ 4 days)
 - **G5 — Inference accuracy:** inference-question subset $\geq 75\%$ across chapter
 - **G6 — Listening doesn't backslide:** still hitting Day-13 Ch.2 level on a quick Listening drill
-

2 · Modified weekly plan (Reading emphasis)

Standard rotation per README § 2.2 still applies. **Three changes:**

1. **Shadowing source** transitions to **dense academic text** — pick *Nature News* / *Science News* full articles (**R-REAL-3** — <https://www.nature.com/news> · <https://www.sciencenews.org>) or longer TED-Ed (**R-SHAD-1** <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>) covering science/history topics. Read-aloud variant allowed (you become your own audio).
2. **Sunday MAIN** changes to **Reading micro-mock** (1 passage, 10 items, strict 15 min).
3. **Anki:** 20 new/day, prioritize **R-ANKI-2** Barron's Essential Words for the TOEFL (<https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/973421516>) and any AWL deck you find through **R-ANKI-1** 4000 Essential English Words (<https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/1104981491>) Book 6.

Weekly cadence

- **Sunday** · MAIN = **Reading micro-mock** (1 passage) · SECONDARY = Writing — Email
- **Monday** · MAIN = **Reading** · SECONDARY = Writing
- **Tuesday** · MAIN = Listening · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Wednesday** · MAIN = Writing · SECONDARY = **Reading** (Complete the Words drill)
- **Thursday** · MAIN = Speaking · SECONDARY = Listening
- **Friday** · MAIN = **Reading** · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Saturday** · MAIN = Listening + Speaking combined · SECONDARY = Writing

Weekly skill counts: R = 3 MAIN + 1 SEC = 4 focused (Sunday MAIN is the Reading micro-mock); L = 1 MAIN + 1 SEC + 1 combined = 3; W = 1 MAIN + 2 SEC = 3; S = 1 MAIN + 2 SEC + 1 combined = 4. 

3 · Daily checklists (14 days)

Day 1 · Mon 6/15 — Reading micro-mock + Email

Today's focus: Open the chapter with a baseline Reading micro-mock so every later day has a starting number to beat.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — 20 new (15 Barron's **R-ANKI-2** <https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/973421516> + 5 4000EEW **R-ANKI-1** <https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/1104981491>) + due reviews
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30 Shadowing** — read-aloud a 60-sec **R-SHAD-3** transcript (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>). Record into Voice Memos as D1_Shadow; then shadow the actual audio.
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading micro-mock** — **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → log in → Reading → pick 1 Module 1 passage (10 items, strict 15-min timer). Log raw score and % in your error log as D1 R-mock.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY** — Email task, 10 min strict, score via **R-AI-2** FluentPrep AI (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>). Record the rubric score.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log — note 1 R error pattern + 1 W rubric weak point.
-

Day 2 · Tue 6/16 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

Today's focus: First real R MAIN — start the error-cause tagging habit that the whole chapter relies on.

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
- ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN** — **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → 1 fresh passage, strict 15 min. **Attribute every wrong answer** with one tag: vocab / inference / detail-misread / time. Log tag counts.
- ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY** — **R-OFF-1** TestReady → Writing → **Build a Sentence** × 8 items. Log accuracy.
- ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log — copy today's R tag counts into a running tally.

 Day 3 · Wed 6/17 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Keep Listening on life-support while Reading takes the spotlight — protect Ch.2 gains.

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Listening MAIN — R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Listening → 1 lecture + 1 conversation. Log accuracy; compare to Ch.2 Day 13 baseline.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY — R-AI-1** PrepEx / Petra (<https://prepex.ai>) → Interview × 2. Save Petra's transcript + score.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log — note any L score drop ≥ 5 pts vs. Ch.2 baseline.
-

 Day 4 · Thu 6/18 — W MAIN / R SECONDARY (Complete the Words)

Today's focus: Introduce the Complete-the-Words sub-task (Goal G3) so morphology drills start accumulating early.

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Writing MAIN — Academic Discussion**, 1 prompt, 10 min strict. Score via **R-AI-2** FluentPrep AI (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>). Log rubric score.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Reading SECONDARY — R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → **Complete the Words** sub-task (letter-blank paragraph). Do 1–2 paragraphs; log correct/total.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log — list every word you missed in CtW for tomorrow's Anki adds.
-

17 Day 5 · Fri 6/19 — S MAIN / L SECONDARY

Today's focus: Keep Speaking reps consistent so Ch.4's Listen & Repeat focus doesn't restart cold.

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Speaking MAIN — R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Speaking → Listen & Repeat × 7, then **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) Interview × 2. Save both audio outputs.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Listening SECONDARY** — 1 lecture from **R-OFF-1** TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>).
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log — note 1 speaking fluency issue (filler / pace / pronunciation).
-

17 Day 6 · Sat 6/20 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Targeted inference work — Goal G5 starts here. The open-book re-do is the actual training, not the timed pass.

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → 1 fresh passage, strict 15 min. After timer: isolate every **inference** question, re-do open-book, and write the supporting line number + a 1-sentence justification.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY — R-AI-1** PrepEx / Petra (<https://prepex.ai>) Interview × 2.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log — log inference accuracy (timed vs. open-book) separately.
-

Day 7 · Sun 6/21 — L+S combined / W secondary

Today's focus: End week 1 with an integrated L+S rep that mimics real exam load; close with a mini-review.

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 L+S combined** — pick a 5–10 min TED talk from **R-SHAD-2** (<https://www.ted.com/talks>, filter 5–10 min). Take Cornell-style notes during; then deliver a 90-sec spoken summary into Voice Memos as D7_LSsummary.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY** — Email task via **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>), 10 min strict.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Weekly mini-review — tally Days 1–7 R tag counts; pick top error category to attack in week 2.
-

Day 8 · Mon 6/22 — Reading micro-mock

Today's focus: Week-2 baseline check — compare today's micro-mock score to Day 1 to confirm upward trend.

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading micro-mock** — fresh passage from **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>), strict 15 min. Log score next to D1 mock for trend.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY** — Email or Academic Discussion via **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) — pick whichever scored lower with **R-AI-2** (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>) earlier this week.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log — note delta vs. Day 1 micro-mock.
-

Day 9 · Tue 6/23 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

Today's focus: Stress-test pacing on a harder passage to surface bottlenecks before the milestone mock.

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN – R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → pick a passage flagged **Module 2** / Advanced (or marked harder), strict 15 min. Log time per item if you blow the timer.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Writing SECONDARY – R-OFF-1** TestReady → Writing → **Build a Sentence** × 8. Log accuracy vs. Day 2.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log – flag any new error tag that wasn't in week 1.
-

Day 10 · Wed 6/24 – L MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Second weekly Listening anchor – confirm L hasn't slipped (Goal G6).

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Listening MAIN – R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Listening → 1 lecture + 1 conversation. Compare accuracy to Day 3.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY – R-AI-1** PrepEx / Petra (<https://prepex.ai>) Interview × 2.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log – note L score vs. Day 3 (Goal G6 check).
-

Day 11 · Thu 6/25 – W MAIN / R SECONDARY

Today's focus: Second Complete-the-Words rep (or real-world reading), plus a second graded Discussion to lock W rhythm.

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
- ☐ **0:30–1:00 Writing MAIN – Academic Discussion** via **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>), 10 min strict. Score via **R-AI-2** FluentPrep AI (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>). Log rubric score vs. Day 4.
- ☐ **1:00–1:20 Reading SECONDARY – read 1 R-REAL-3** *Nature News* / *Science News* article (<https://www.nature.com/news> · <https://www.sciencenews.org>), 1-

paragraph written summary; OR another **R-OFF-1** Complete-the-Words drill (1 paragraph, log score).

- ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log — note CtW score vs. Day 4 if you chose that path.
-

Day 12 · Fri 6/26 — S MAIN / L SECONDARY

Today's focus: Second weekly Speaking anchor — keep fluency warm before Ch.4's full Speaking pivot.

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Speaking MAIN — R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Speaking → Listen & Repeat × 7, then **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) Interview × 2.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Listening SECONDARY —** 1 lecture from **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>).
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log — log L&R accuracy vs. Day 5.
-

Day 13 · Sat 6/27 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Last R rep before the milestone mock — taper, don't overload. Confirm pacing is comfortable at 15 min.

- ☐ Anki + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → 1 fresh passage, strict 15 min. If you finish ≤ 14 min comfortably, Goal G2 is on track.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:20 Speaking SECONDARY — R-AI-1** PrepEx / Petra (<https://prepex.ai>) Interview × 2.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Error log — write 1-line prediction of tomorrow's milestone mock score.
-

17 Day 14 · Sun 6/28 — 🎯 Milestone 1 mock + Bi-week review

Today's focus: Milestone 1 — full Reading Section under exam timing decides whether Ch.4 proceeds normally or with R remediation.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — due reviews only (no new cards before a mock).
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing — light **R-SHAD-3** (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>) to warm up; skip the recording pass today.
 - ☐ **0:30–1:10** 🎯 **Milestone 1 mock — R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → full Section (Module 1 + Module 2). Strict timing, no pauses. **Milestone gate:** Module 1 ≥ 85% required to proceed without remediation. Record raw + % per module.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Fill out the Ch.3 Review Card below; mark PASS/HOLD/REDO and any Ch.4 modification orders.
-

4 · Ch.3 Review Card (Day 14)

Ch.3 Review (6/28) — Milestone 1

Milestone 1: Reading Module 1

- Score: ___ / ___ → %: ___
- ****PASS**** (≥ 85%) / ****HOLD**** (75–84%, do 1 more week of R drills in Ch.4) / ****REDO**** (< 75%, extend R focus into Ch.4)

Goals self-check

- [] G1 Module 1 ≥ 85%
- [] G2 1 passage ≤ 15 min comfortable
- [] G3 Complete-the-Words ≥ 8/10
- [] G4 200 new Anki cards mature
- [] G5 Inference subset ≥ 75%
- [] G6 Listening hasn't slipped

Pattern data

- Most common R error cause tag: _____
- Most common R question type missed: _____ (inference / vocab-in-context / detail / negative-fact / paragraph-purpose)
- Average time per passage: ___ min

Modification orders for Ch.4 (Speaking – Listen & Repeat)

- If Milestone 1 = RED0 → keep Reading MAIN at 3×/week in Ch.4 (don't drop to 2)
 - If inference-type errors dominate → add 5-min "inference logic" warm-up daily in Ch.4
 - If Complete-the-Words < 8/10 → daily 1-paragraph CtW drill, every day in Ch.4
-

5 · Common pitfalls in this chapter

1. **"I understand the passage" ≠ "I'll get the questions right."** Comprehension and question-targeting are separate skills. Train them separately: read for gist → re-read for the specific question's evidence.
2. **Vocab-in-context is a free point** if your Anki habit holds. If you're missing those, you're behind on Anki, not on reading.
3. **Inference is not guessing.** Every inference answer is supported by a specific line in the text. Train yourself to **point to the line** before locking an answer.
4. **Complete the Words tests morphology + spelling, not meaning.** Practice prefixes/suffixes separately; many missed letters are predictable from word family (e.g., *-tion*, *-ment*, *un-*, *in-*).
5. **Don't skip Listening this chapter.** The Ch.2 gains evaporate in 2 weeks if you stop.

Ch.4 · Speaking – Listen & Repeat Focus (6/29 – 7/12)

Days: 14 (Day 1 = Mon 6/29, Day 14 = Sun 7/12) **Emphasis:** Speaking Task 1 (Listen & Repeat). Shadowing intensified. **Skill coverage:** Every day touches ≥ 2 skills. Anki + Shadowing remain floor (and Shadowing today becomes *the* training, not warm-up). **Deliverables:** Listen & Repeat exact-match rate ≥ 80% on a 7-item fresh set + auditory memory span of 12+ words + clear consonant articulation under speed.

1 · Why this chapter exists

The new TOEFL 2026 Speaking Section is 7 **Listen & Repeat items** + 4 **Interview items**. There is **no preparation time** for either. The Listen & Repeat task tests:

- **Auditory memory** (can you hold 8–15 words in working memory for ~3 sec)
- **Pronunciation fidelity** (consonant clusters, final consonants, linked sounds)
- **Prosody match** (stress, rhythm, intonation)
- **Speed of decoding** (no time to “think about” what you heard)

These are **exactly** what shadowing trains. Hamada (2016) and the 2025 Tandfon-line systematic review converge: 4–6 weeks of daily shadowing → measurable gains on all four. This chapter doubles down.

2 · Chapter goals (self-assess Day 14)

- **G1 — L&R exact-match rate ≥ 80%:** 7-item fresh set, recorded, scored by AI + self
 - **G2 — Auditory memory span:** can repeat a 12-word novel sentence after one hearing, with ≤ 2 word errors
 - **G3 — Consonant clarity:** final consonants and *th* / *v* / *r* sounds intelligible to AI scorer
 - **G4 — Shadowing volume:** ≥ 14 sessions in chapter (= daily), with last-week recordings noticeably better than first-week
 - **G5 — Other skills maintained:** Reading Module 1 still $\geq 80\%$; Listening lecture still $\geq 5/6$
 - **G6 — Interview not neglected:** at least 4 Interview practice sessions completed (prep for Ch.6)
-

3 · Modified weekly plan (Speaking L&R emphasis)

Three changes:

1. **Shadowing time doubles** — go from 15 min → **30 min** every day. The block 0:20–0:50 is all shadowing.
2. **Daily 5-min “sentence-level Listen & Repeat” drill** added between Anki and Shadowing — using **R-SHAD-3** Scientific American 60-Second Science (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>).
3. The Sunday MAIN slot becomes a **7-item L&R micro-mock**.

New daily template for Ch.4 (still 90 min total):

00:00–00:15 | Anki

00:15–00:20 | Sentence-level L&R drill (5 single-sentence repeats)

00:20–00:50 | Shadowing (30 min – extended)
 00:50–01:20 | Day's MAIN skill
 01:20–01:30 | Day's SECONDARY + error log condensed

The MAIN/SECONDARY rotation continues; the SECONDARY block compresses from 20 to 10 min (just a touchpoint, not deep practice). Because Shadowing is doubled, L+S touchpoints are extreme.

Weekly cadence

- **Sunday** · MAIN = **L&R 7-item micro-mock** · SECONDARY = Writing — 1 Build-a-Sentence (the 10-min compressed SEC slot doesn't fit a strict-10-min Email)
- **Monday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Writing
- **Tuesday** · MAIN = Listening · SECONDARY = **Speaking — Interview**
- **Wednesday** · MAIN = Writing · SECONDARY = Reading
- **Thursday** · MAIN = **Speaking — L&R deep drill** · SECONDARY = Listening
- **Friday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = **Speaking — Interview**
- **Saturday** · MAIN = L+S combined (lecture summary) · SECONDARY = Writing

Weekly counts (incl. doubled Shadowing as L+S): S = 2 MAIN + 2 SEC + 1 combined + 14 shadow + 7 sentence drills = saturated; R = 2 MAIN + 1 SEC = 3; L = 1 MAIN + 1 SEC + 1 combined + 14 shadows = 17 touches; W = 1 MAIN + 2 SEC = 3. 

4 · Daily checklists (14 days)

Day 1 · Mon 6/29 — L&R micro-mock + Shadowing extended

Today's focus: Set the chapter baseline — record a 7-item L&R micro-mock and double the shadowing block so every later day has something to beat.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — 20 new, prioritize **R-ANKI-2** Barron's TOEFL (<https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/973421516>); clear all due reviews
- ☐ **0:15–0:20 Sentence-level L&R drill** — Open **R-SHAD-3** Scientific American 60-Second Science (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>). Play any episode. Pick 5 sentences (~8–15 words each). For

each: pause after the sentence → repeat aloud from memory → re-listen. Tally how many you nailed verbatim (target $\geq 3/5$).

- ☐ **0:20–0:50 Shadowing 30 min** — Pick a 5-min TED-Ed (**R-SHAD-1**, <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>). Run **3-pass protocol twice** (= 6 passes total): each cycle is blind → transcript → record-compare. Save recording as D1_Shadow for end-of-chapter A/B compare.
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 L&R 7-item micro-mock** — **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → log in → Speaking section → Listen & Repeat task. Record each item into phone Voice Memos as D1_LR_1...D1_LR_7. Upload to **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) for scoring. Log exact-match count (X/7) in Ch.4 Review Card under “Day 1 baseline”.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Writing SECONDARY** — 1 Build-a-Sentence item from **R-OFF-1**, log any grammar slip in error log
-

Day 2 · Tue 6/30 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

Today’s focus: Preserve Reading accuracy under the new Speaking-heavy template — prove one MAIN slot still hits Module 1 $\geq 80\%$.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15 Anki** — 20 new + reviews
 - ☐ **0:15–0:20 Sentence-level L&R drill** — 5 sentences from **R-SHAD-3** (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>)
 - ☐ **0:20–0:50 Shadowing 30 min** — same TED-Ed video as Day 1 OR pick a new 5-min **R-SHAD-1** (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>); 3-pass protocol $\times 2$
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 Reading MAIN** — **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → 1 passage, strict 15-min timer. Use remaining time for error attribution (vocab / inference / detail / negative-factual). Log Module 1 % — aim $\geq 80\%$.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Writing SECONDARY** — Build a Sentence $\times 5$ from **R-OFF-1** Writing section + error log
-

Day 3 · Wed 7/1 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY (Interview)

Today's focus: Keep Listening lecture comprehension at $\geq 5/6$ and start banking weekly Interview reps so Ch.6 doesn't start cold.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + reviews) + Sentence-level L&R drill (5 from **R-SHAD-3**) + Shadowing 30 min (3-pass $\times$ 2 on **R-SHAD-1**)
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 Listening MAIN — R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) $\rightarrow$ Listening $\rightarrow$ 1 lecture + 1 conversation, take Cornell-style notes. Score; target lecture $\geq 5/6$. Log result.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY — Interview — R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) $\rightarrow$ Interview mode $\rightarrow$ 2 questions back-to-back. Record. Capture 1-line error per response (filler word / grammar / vagueness).
-

Day 4 · Thu 7/2 — W MAIN / R SECONDARY

Today's focus: Hold Writing Discussion rhythm with a single hard-timed rep so Ch.5 starts from a known score.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + ~60 reviews) + Sentence-level L&R drill — 5 sentences from **R-SHAD-3** Scientific American 60-Second Science (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>) + Shadowing 30 min — pick a 5-min **R-SHAD-1** TED-Ed (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>), 3-pass protocol $\times$ 2
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 Writing MAIN — R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) $\rightarrow$ Writing $\rightarrow$ Discussion task, strict 10-min timer. Paste response into **R-AI-2** FluentPrep (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>) for rubric scoring. Log score and 1 weakness.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Reading SECONDARY — 1 Complete-the-Words** paragraph from **R-OFF-1** + error log
-

17 Day 5 · Fri 7/3 — S MAIN (L&R deep drill) / L SECONDARY

Today's focus: First volume push — 14 L&R items with explicit re-take, so the failure modes (memory / pronunciation / speed / stress) become diagnosable.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + ~60 reviews) + Sentence-level L&R drill — 5 sentences from **R-SHAD-3** Scientific American 60-Second Science (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>) + Shadowing 30 min — pick a 5-min **R-SHAD-1** TED-Ed (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>), 3-pass protocol × 2
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 L&R deep drill** — 14 items total: 7 from **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) Speaking → L&R + 7 from **R-FREE-3** TestSucceed (https://testsucceed.com/materials/tests/toefl_new) → Speaking samples. For each item: blind take (record) → re-listen to original → corrected take (record). Save pair as D5_LR_{n}a/D5_LR_{n}b. After all 14, tag each miss with one of: memory / pronunciation / speed / stress.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Listening SECONDARY — 1 short conversation set from **R-OFF-1** + error log
-

17 Day 6 · Sat 7/4 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY (Interview)

Today's focus: Second Reading MAIN this week + second Interview rep — both maintenance, no new mechanics.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + ~60 reviews) + Sentence-level L&R drill — 5 sentences from **R-SHAD-3** Scientific American 60-Second Science (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>) + Shadowing 30 min — pick a 5-min **R-SHAD-1** TED-Ed (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>), 3-pass protocol × 2
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 Reading MAIN** — **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → 1 passage, strict 15-min timer + error attribution. Log Module 1 %.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY** — **Interview** — **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) Interview × 2 questions; log 1 error per response
-

Day 7 · Sun 7/5 — L+S combined / W secondary

Today's focus: Bridge Listening and Speaking under one task — a lecture-summary rep that previews Ch.8's integrated work.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + ~60 reviews) + Sentence-level L&R drill — 5 sentences from **R-SHAD-3** Scientific American 60-Second Science (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>) + Shadowing 30 min — pick a 5-min **R-SHAD-1** TED-Ed (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>), 3-pass protocol × 2
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 L+S combined** — Pick a 10-min talk from **R-SHAD-2** TED Talks (<https://www.ted.com/talks>), filter 5–10 min. Listen once with notes. Record a 90-sec spoken summary into Voice Memos as D7_Summary. Re-listen to original; mark any key point you missed.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Email task from **R-OFF-1**, 10 min + weekly mini-review (skim week's error log, pick top 1 recurring issue to watch next week)
-

Day 8 · Mon 7/6 — L&R micro-mock (compare to Day 1)

Today's focus: First trend check — same protocol as Day 1, so the delta is the only signal.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + ~60 reviews) + Sentence-level L&R drill — 5 sentences from **R-SHAD-3** Scientific American 60-Second Science (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>) + Shadowing 30 min — pick a 5-min **R-SHAD-1** TED-Ed (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>), 3-pass protocol × 2
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 L&R micro-mock** — **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Speaking → Listen & Repeat, fresh 7-item set (not items used Day 1 or Day 5). Record as D8_LR_1...D8_LR_7. Score via **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>). Log exact-match count under “Day 8 mid-point” in Review Card. **Compare to Day 1 baseline** — note delta.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — 1 Build-a-Sentence from **R-OFF-1** + error log
-

Day 9 · Tue 7/7 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

Today's focus: Week-2 Reading maintenance — confirm Module 1 hasn't slipped under the doubled Speaking load.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + ~60 reviews) + Sentence-level L&R drill — 5 sentences from **R-SHAD-3** Scientific American 60-Second Science (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>) + Shadowing 30 min — pick a 5-min **R-SHAD-1** TED-Ed (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>), 3-pass protocol × 2
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20** Reading MAIN — **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → 1 passage, strict 15-min timer + error attribution. Log Module 1 %; flag drop vs. Day 2/6.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Build a Sentence × 5 from **R-OFF-1** + error log
-

Day 10 · Wed 7/8 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY (Interview)

Today's focus: Hold lecture comprehension at chapter goal and bank Interview rep #3.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + ~60 reviews) + Sentence-level L&R drill — 5 sentences from **R-SHAD-3** Scientific American 60-Second Science (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>) + Shadowing 30 min — pick a 5-min **R-SHAD-1** TED-Ed (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>), 3-pass protocol × 2
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20** Listening MAIN — **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Listening → 1 lecture + 1 conversation, Cornell notes. Score; lecture target ≥ 5/6.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) Interview × 2 + 1-line error log per response
-

Day 11 · Thu 7/9 — W MAIN / R SECONDARY

Today's focus: Second Writing Discussion rep of the chapter — track score delta vs. Day 4.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + ~60 reviews) + Sentence-level L&R drill — 5 sentences from **R-SHAD-3** Scientific American 60-Second Science (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>) + Shadowing 30 min — pick a 5-min **R-SHAD-1** TED-Ed (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>), 3-pass protocol × 2
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20** Writing MAIN — **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Writing → Discussion, strict 10-min timer. Score in **R-AI-2** FluentPrep (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>). Log score, compare to Day 4.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Reading SECONDARY — 1 Complete-the-Words drill from **R-OFF-1** + error log
-

Day 12 · Fri 7/10 — S MAIN (L&R deep drill v2) / L SECONDARY

Today's focus: Speed-overload the L&R skill so real-time pace feels easy on Day 14 showcase.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + ~60 reviews) + Sentence-level L&R drill — 5 sentences from **R-SHAD-3** Scientific American 60-Second Science (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>) + Shadowing 30 min — pick a 5-min **R-SHAD-1** TED-Ed (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>), 3-pass protocol × 2
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 L&R deep drill v2** — 14 items with **speed pressure** at 1.1× playback. In **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>), use browser playback-speed control (or download audio + Audacity/VLC at 1.1×). Sources: 7 from R-OFF-1 L&R + 7 from **R-FREE-3** (https://testsucceed.com/materials/tests/toefl_new). Record each, tag failure mode (memory / pronunciation / speed / stress). Note which mode dominates.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Listening SECONDARY — 1 conversation from **R-OFF-1** + error log
-

17 Day 13 · Sat 7/11 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Final Reading touch + final Interview rep (=4) before showcase day; also record a Day-13 shadowing clip for end-of-chapter A/B.

- ☐ Anki (20 new + ~60 reviews) + Sentence-level L&R drill — 5 sentences from **R-SHAD-3** Scientific American 60-Second Science (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>) + Shadowing 30 min — pick a 5-min **R-SHAD-1** TED-Ed (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>), 3-pass protocol × 2. Save today's record-compare clip as D13_Shadow for tomorrow's A/B vs. D1_Shadow.
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20** Reading MAIN — **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → 1 passage, strict 15 min + error attribution.
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) Interview × 2 + error log
-

17 Day 14 · Sun 7/12 — 🎯 Bi-week review + Showcase L&R + Listening preserve mock

Today's focus: Verdict day — score the showcase L&R against the ≥ 80% chapter goal and fill in the Ch.4 Review Card that drives Ch.5 modifications.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — clear all due reviews
- ☐ **0:15–0:20** Sentence-level L&R drill — 5 from **R-SHAD-3** (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>), one last time
- ☐ **0:20–0:50** Shadowing 30 min — **R-SHAD-1** (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>), 3-pass × 2. Then play D1_Shadow and D13_Shadow back to back; note “improvement: Yes / Partial / No” for Review Card.
- ☐ **0:50–1:15** 🎯 **Showcase L&R** — **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Speaking → L&R, fresh 7-item set. Record as D14_LR_1...D14_LR_7. Score via **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) + self-check. Goal: ≥ 80% exact match (≥ 6/7). Also run the 12-word novel-sentence test once (ask a friend or use a fresh **R-SHAD-3** sentence) and log error count.

- ☐ **1:15–1:30 Listening preserve drill** — 5 items from a fresh **R-OFF-1** lecture, **no notes** today (test bare recall). Log _/5. Then fill in the Ch.4 Review Card below.
-

5 · Ch.4 Review Card (Day 14)

Ch.4 Review (7/12)

Goal: Listen & Repeat exact-match ≥ 80%

- Day 1 baseline: __ / 7
- Day 8 mid-point: __ / 7
- Day 14 showcase: __ / 7 → %: __
- ****PASS**** (≥ 80%) / ****HOLD**** (60–80%) / ****REDO**** (< 60%)

Diagnostic

- Most common L&R failure mode: _____ (memory drop / pronunciation / speed / stress)
- 12-word novel sentence test (one trial today): repeated with __ errors
- Listening preserve drill score: __ / 5

Shadowing reflection

- Re-listened to Day 1 vs Day 13 recording – visible improvement? Yes / Partial / No
- If "No" → diagnose: am I doing the 3-pass protocol fully? Recording every session?

Modification orders for Ch.5 (Writing – Email + Build a Sentence)

- If L&R < 80% → keep 30-min Shadowing daily in Ch.5 (don't drop to 15)
 - If memory drop dominant → daily "11+ word sentence" repetition drill, 5 sentences
 - If pronunciation dominant → add 5-min minimal-pair drill (see resource note below)
-

6 · Common pitfalls in this chapter

1. **Recording is not optional.** You can't hear your own pronunciation errors live — only on playback. If you skip recording, the chapter doesn't work.

2. **3-pass protocol matters.** “Blind shadow only” gives ~50% of the benefit. The transcript pass exposes what you missed; the record-compare pass closes the loop.
3. **Don’t memorize sentences.** L&R items are random. The skill is *generalized auditory memory*, not “I happen to know this sentence.”
4. **Match stress, not just words.** AI scorers (and ETS) weigh prosody. Saying every syllable correctly but flat = lower score than 1 word wrong + good stress.
5. **Minimal-pair work** if pronunciation is your bottleneck: free resource is **Cambridge Sounds Pronunciation Drills** (search YouTube) — focus on /θ/ / ð/ /r/ /l/ /v/ /w/.
6. **Don’t sacrifice Reading/Listening this chapter.** The plan keeps them at MAIN slots for a reason — gains evaporate fast.

Ch.5 • Writing — Email + Build a Sentence (7/13 – 7/26)

Days: 14 (Day 1 = Mon 7/13, Day 14 = Sun 7/26) **Emphasis:** Writing — Email task + Build a Sentence sub-task. **Skill coverage:** Every day touches ≥ 2 skills. Anki + Shadowing remain floor (Shadowing resets to 15 min). **Deliverables:** Email 100 words in ≤ **10 min** reliably + Build-a-Sentence ≥ 9/10 + Milestone 2 (Listening ≥ 24/30 raw, L&R ≥ 80%) hit on Day 14.

1 • Why Email is its own chapter

In the new TOEFL 2026 Writing section, Email is **its own scored task** (not a warm-up). It tests:

- **Register awareness** (professor vs. peer vs. admin staff)
- **Functional clarity** (greeting → context → request → close)
- **Polite directness** — neither blunt nor over-padded
- **Grammar and word choice under time pressure** (10 min hard ceiling)

Build a Sentence tests pure **syntactic competence** — word-order under time pressure. Both reward **clean, simple structures** over showy vocabulary.

2 • Chapter goals (self-assess Day 14)

- **G1 — Email 100 words ≤ 10 min:** reliably (3+ successful runs in chapter)

- **G2 — Email register:** 3 distinct register exemplars written (formal-prof / semi-formal-TA / peer)
 - **G3 — Build a Sentence:** $\geq 9/10$ on a fresh 10-item set
 - **G4 — Milestone 2 (Listening $\geq 24/30$ raw):** showcase Listening mock on Day 14
 - **G5 — Milestone 2 (L&R $\geq 80\%$):** 7-item set on Day 14
 - **G6 — Discussion not neglected:** at least 4 Discussion practice runs completed
-

3 · Modified weekly plan (Writing — Email emphasis)

Three changes:

1. **Shadowing resets to 15 min** (Ch.4 doubled it; now back to floor).
2. **Daily “1 Email or 5 Build-a-Sentence items” micro-drill** between Anki and Shadowing (10 min).
3. **Sunday MAIN** = Email under exam conditions + immediate AI feedback review.

Weekly cadence

- **Sunday** · MAIN = **Writing — Email + feedback review** · SECONDARY = Short Listening mock (6 items)
- **Monday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = **Writing — Build a Sentence**
- **Tuesday** · MAIN = Listening · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Wednesday** · MAIN = **Writing — Email** · SECONDARY = Reading
- **Thursday** · MAIN = Speaking · SECONDARY = Listening
- **Friday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Saturday** · MAIN = L+S combined · SECONDARY = **Writing — Discussion**

Weekly counts: W = 2 MAIN + 1 SEC + 1 Sat-SEC + 7 micro-drills = 11 touches; R = 2 MAIN + 1 SEC = 3; L = 1 MAIN + 1 SEC + 1 combined + 1 Sun-SEC = 4; S = 1 MAIN + 2 SEC + 1 combined = 4. 

4 · Daily checklists (14 days)

17 Day 1 · Mon 7/13 — Email exam-condition mock + feedback

Today's focus: First exam-condition Email under strict 10 min + AI rubric scoring — sets the baseline for chapter comparisons.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — 20 new (continue Barron's TOEFL deck **R-ANKI-2**, <https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/973421516>); clear all due reviews.
 - ☐ **0:15–0:25 Writing micro-drill** — Build a Sentence × 5 items (**R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady, <https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html> → Writing → Build a Sentence practice). Log any miss in error log.
 - ☐ **0:25–0:40 Shadowing 15 min** — back to baseline. TED-Ed (**R-SHAD-1**, <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>) 5-min video, 3-pass protocol. Save recording as D1_Shadow.
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 Writing MAIN — Email — R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → log in → Writing section → Email task. **Strict 10 min timer.** Pick **formal-professor** register today (reserve TA/peer for Day 4 + Day 11). Save the email text as D1_Email_prof. Immediately paste it into **R-AI-2** FluentPrep (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>). Spend the rest of the slot reading the rubric breakdown and noting **2 concrete improvements** in the error log.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Listening SECONDARY** — 1 conversation set (5 items, ~10 min) from **R-OFF-1** → Listening → Conversation. Log incorrect items + reason (vocabulary / inference / detail) in error log.
-

17 Day 2 · Tue 7/14 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY (Build a Sentence)

Today's focus: Reading reps + first dedicated 10-item Build-a-Sentence set for grammar baseline.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — 20 new + due reviews.
- ☐ **0:15–0:25** Writing micro-drill — 1 Email **outline only** (greeting / context / ask / close — 5 lines, 3 min). No full prose; just confirm the 4-part skeleton is instinctive.

- ☐ **0:25–0:40** Shadowing 15 min (TED-Ed, 3-pass).
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → 1 passage, **strict 15 min**, + attribution sub-task. Log score __/10 and any missed question type.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Writing SECONDARY — Build a Sentence** × 10 items from **R-OFF-1** → Writing → Build a Sentence. Target ≥ 8/10; log misses with the correct word-order pattern.
-

Day 3 · Wed 7/15 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Mid-week Listening volume + Speaking touch via Interview reps.

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill (5 Build-a-Sentence from **R-OFF-1**) + Shadowing 15 min (TED-Ed **R-SHAD-1**, <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>).
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 Listening MAIN — R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Listening: 1 lecture + 1 conversation. Log raw __/11 and note any inference-question misses.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY** — Petra Interview × 2 via **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>). Record into phone Voice Memos as D3_Speak_1 / D3_Speak_2; log fluency rating + 1 fix per response.
-

Day 4 · Thu 7/16 — W MAIN (Email) / R SECONDARY

Today's focus: Second Email — new register (semi-formal TA) to start G2 register-variety goal.

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill (5 Build-a-Sentence from **R-OFF-1**) + Shadowing 15 min.
- ☐ **0:40–1:10 Writing MAIN — Email — R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Writing → Email. Pick a register you haven't practiced (e.g., **request to a TA** if Day 1 was **professor**). 10 min strict. Save as D4_Email_TA, paste into **R-AI-2** FluentPrep (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>), log 2 fixes.

- ☐ **1:10–1:30 Reading SECONDARY** — 1 Complete-the-Words drill from **R-OFF-1** → Reading → Complete the Words; log misses + correct collocations in error log.
-

Day 5 · Fri 7/17 — S MAIN / L SECONDARY

Today's focus: Keep L&R muscle alive ($\geq 80\%$ target for Milestone 2) + Interview reps.

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill (5 Build-a-Sentence) + Shadowing 15 min.
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 Speaking MAIN — R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Speaking → Listen & Repeat $\times 7$ (track exact-match %, aim $\geq 80\%$); then Interview $\times 2$ via **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>). Save Voice Memo as D5_Speak.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Listening SECONDARY** — 1 lecture from **R-OFF-1** → Listening → Lecture; log raw + error log.
-

Day 6 · Sat 7/18 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Reading volume + Speaking touch to keep skill rotation even.

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill (5 Build-a-Sentence) + Shadowing 15 min.
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 Reading MAIN — R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → 1 passage, strict 15 min. Log ___/10 + question-type misses.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY** — Petra Interview $\times 2$ via **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>). Save as D6_Speak; log 1 fix per response.
-

Day 7 · Sun 7/19 — L+S combined / W secondary (Discussion)

Today's focus: End-of-week integration (listen → speak) + first Discussion rep toward G6.

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill (5 Build-a-Sentence) + Shadowing 15 min.
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 L+S combined** — TED talk 5–10 min from **R-SHAD-2** TED Talks (<https://www.ted.com/talks>, filter 5–10 min). Listen straight through, then deliver a **90-sec spoken summary** into Voice Memos (D7_Summary). Compare against transcript; note 2 missed key points.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Writing SECONDARY — Discussion** — 200-word prompt, 10 min strict, via **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Writing → Discussion (or **R-FREE-5** TOEFLResources.com, <https://www.toeflresources.com/> for a prompt). Paste into **R-AI-2** FluentPrep (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>). Then write 3-line weekly mini-review (what worked / what dropped / one tweak).
-

Day 8 · Mon 7/20 — Email + feedback review v2

Today's focus: Second exam-condition Email + side-by-side natural-language comparison against Day 1 baseline.

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill (5 Build-a-Sentence from **R-OFF-1**) + Shadowing 15 min.
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 Writing MAIN — Email — R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Writing → Email, 10 min strict. Save as D8_Email. **Then:** paste both D1_Email_prof and D8_Email into **R-AI-5** (ChatGPT <https://chat.openai.com> or Claude <https://claude.ai>) and ask “which is more natural, which has clearer asks, what specifically improved?” Log the 2 most actionable diffs.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Listening SECONDARY** — 1 conversation from **R-OFF-1** → Listening → Conversation; log raw __/5 + error log.
-

Day 9 · Tue 7/21 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

Today's focus: Second Build-a-Sentence 10-item set to track G3 progress (target $\geq 9/10$ by Day 14).

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill (1 Email outline, 4-part skeleton) + Shadowing 15 min.
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Reading MAIN — **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → 1 passage, strict 15 min. Log ___/10.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Build a Sentence × 10 from **R-OFF-1** → Writing → Build a Sentence. Compare score against Day 2's set; log misses by pattern type (inversion / adverb / comparative / clause order).
-

Day 10 · Wed 7/22 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Listening volume rep — dress rehearsal for Milestone 2 full Listening section on Day 14.

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill (5 Build-a-Sentence) + Shadowing 15 min.
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Listening MAIN — **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Listening: 1 lecture + 1 conversation. Log raw ___/11; flag any topic area (bio / art / history) that you keep missing.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — Petra × 2 via **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>). Save as D10_Speak; log 1 fix per response.
-

Day 11 · Thu 7/23 — W MAIN (Email register variety) / R SECONDARY

Today's focus: Third Email register — completes G2 (professor / TA / peer) register-variety goal.

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill (5 Build-a-Sentence) + Shadowing 15 min.
- ☐ **0:40–1:10** Writing MAIN — **Email** — **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Writing → Email. Pick a 3rd register (e.g., **classmate group-project coordination** — peer-level). 10 min strict. Save as D11_Email_peer, paste into **R-AI-2** FluentPrep (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>); log 2 fixes.
- ☐ **1:10–1:30** Reading SECONDARY — 1 Complete-the-Words from **R-OFF-1** OR 1 article from **R-REAL-3** Nature News / Science News (<https://www.nature>).

com/news or <https://www.sciencenews.org>). Log misses or 3 new science vocab terms.

Day 12 · Fri 7/24 — S MAIN / L SECONDARY

Today's focus: Last L&R rehearsal before Milestone 2 L&R showcase (Day 14) — must be $\geq 80\%$.

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill (5 Build-a-Sentence) + Shadowing 15 min.
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Speaking MAIN — **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Speaking → Listen & Repeat × 7 (track exact-match %; this is the Milestone 2 dress rehearsal — aim $\geq 80\%$); then Interview × 2 via **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>). Save as D12_Speak.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Listening SECONDARY — 1 lecture from **R-OFF-1** → Listening → Lecture; log raw + error log.
-

Day 13 · Sat 7/25 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Final taper day — light reps before Milestone 2 mock tomorrow.

- ☐ Anki + Writing micro-drill (5 Build-a-Sentence) + Shadowing 15 min.
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Reading MAIN — **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → 1 passage, strict 15 min. Log ___/10.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — Petra × 2 via **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>). Save as D13_Speak; log 1 fix. **Then prep for tomorrow:** pre-load **R-OFF-1** Listening Section + L&R set in browser tabs.
-

Day 14 · Sun 7/26 — 🎯 Milestone 2 mock + Bi-week review

Today's focus: Milestone 2 combined showcase (Listening + L&R) + fill in Ch.5 Review Card to decide Ch.6 modifications.

Milestone 2 (combined): Listening showcase + L&R showcase.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki + due reviews (no new cards today – pure consolidation).
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing 15 min (TED-Ed **R-SHAD-1**, <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>) – easy warm-up only.
 - ☐ **0:30–1:15** 🎯 **Milestone 2 mock** (single sitting, no breaks):
 - Full Listening Section (both modules) from **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Listening → Full Section → target: raw $\geq 24/30$. Log raw __/30 in Review Card.
 - 7-item L&R **fresh set** (not seen this chapter) from **R-OFF-1** → Speaking → Listen & Repeat → target: exact-match $\geq 80\%$. Log __/7 in Review Card.
 - ☐ **1:15–1:30** Fill in **Ch.5 Review Card** (§ 5 below) – record Milestone 2 results, tick G1–G6, and write Ch.6 modification orders.
-

5 · Ch.5 Review Card (Day 14)

Ch.5 Review (7/26) – Milestone 2

Milestone 2 results

- Listening raw: __ / 30 → ****PASS**** (≥ 24) / ****HOLD**** (20–23) / ****REDO**** (< 20)
- L&R exact-match: __ / 7 → ****PASS**** ($\geq 80\%$) / ****HOLD**** / ****REDO****

Goals self-check

- [] G1 Email 100 words ≤ 10 min reliably (3+ runs)
- [] G2 3 register exemplars written (professor / TA / peer)
- [] G3 Build-a-Sentence $\geq 9/10$ fresh
- [] G4 Listening $\geq 24/30$
- [] G5 L&R $\geq 80\%$
- [] G6 ≥ 4 Discussion practice runs done

Email diagnostic

- Strongest register: _____
- Weakest register: _____ – fix: _____
- AI rubric area most often flagged: _____ (delivery / vocabulary / grammar / task achievement)

Modification orders for Ch.6 (Speaking – Interview + AI dialogue)

- If Milestone 2 Listening REDO → re-introduce L MAIN $\times 3$ /week in

Ch.6

- If L&R REDO → keep 30-min Shadowing in Ch.6 (rollback to Ch.4 style)
 - If Email register inconsistent → add 1 register-specific Email/week in Ch.6
-

6 • Common pitfalls

1. **Email is short — don't pad.** 100 words means 100 words. AI scorers (and ETS) penalize padding ("I would like to take this opportunity to..."). Be functional.
2. **Greeting + close take 15% of your word count.** Budget for it. Don't waste space on flourishes.
3. **Build a Sentence is grammar, not style.** If you miss items, drill **word order** (subject-verb-object inversions, adverb placement, comparatives) — don't add vocabulary.
4. **AI scoring on Email is mediocre** — heavily weight your own re-read. ChatGPT/Claude are better for "is this natural?" than for numeric scores.
5. **Don't let L&R rot.** It needed 14 days of intensity to build; it can lose 30% in 14 days of neglect. Keep the L&R micro-drill alive in Ch.5+.

Ch.6 • Speaking — Interview + AI Dialogue (7/27 – 8/9)

Days: 14 (Day 1 = Mon 7/27, Day 14 = Sun 8/9) **Emphasis:** Speaking Task 2 (Interview, 45-sec spontaneous answers). Heavy use of conversational AI.
Skill coverage: Every day touches ≥ 2 skills. Anki + Shadowing floor.
Deliverables: 45-sec Interview answers with reliable **Idea / Reason / Tie-in** structure + 4 distinct topic categories rehearsed + AI delivery score trending up across chapter.

1 • Why Interview is hard (and why AI helps)

The new TOEFL 2026 Interview task asks 4 questions, each 45 sec, **with no preparation time**. ETS samples cluster into 3 styles:

- **Opinion/preference:** "Do you prefer studying alone or in a group? Why?"
- **Memory/experience:** "Describe a place you visited that surprised you."
- **Lifestyle/routine:** "How do you usually relax after a stressful week?"

Standard prep mistake: students “prepare” 50 canned topics. The new AI scorer **detects canned answers** and penalizes them. What works instead:

1. **Structural fluency** — Idea (0–15s) → Reason (15–30s) → Tie-in (30–45s).
Apply *any* topic, on the fly.
 2. **Volume of spontaneous reps** — only a conversational AI (**R-AI-1** PrepEx Petra, <https://prepex.ai>) can give you 50+ unique reps in 2 weeks.
 3. **Delivery > complexity** — clarity, pace, intelligibility beat vocabulary fire-works.
-

2 · Chapter goals

- **G1 — Interview structure:** Idea / Reason / Tie-in framing visible in $\geq 80\%$ of recordings
 - **G2 — Topic breadth:** 4 categories rehearsed — opinion / memory / lifestyle / hypothetical
 - **G3 — AI delivery score:** Petra/FluentPrep “Delivery” score trends up across chapter
 - **G4 — Time control:** all 4 answers land 40–45 sec (no truncation, no run-over)
 - **G5 — L&R doesn’t regress:** a weekly 7-item L&R drill stays $\geq 80\%$
 - **G6 — Other skills maintained:** Reading, Listening, Writing rotation intact
-

3 · Modified weekly plan (Speaking — Interview emphasis)

Three changes:

1. **Daily 10-min Petra (R-AI-1, <https://prepex.ai>) Interview session** is added between Anki and Shadowing.
2. **Sunday MAIN** = 4-item Interview micro-mock (mimics real test).
3. **Recording archive:** every Interview recording saved with date and topic; weekly comparison built into Day 7/14.

Weekly cadence

- **Sunday** · MAIN = **Interview 4-item mock** · SECONDARY = Writing — Email
- **Monday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Writing
- **Tuesday** · MAIN = Listening · SECONDARY = **Speaking — Interview deep drill**
- **Wednesday** · MAIN = Writing · SECONDARY = Reading

- **Thursday** · MAIN = **Speaking — Interview + L&R refresh** · SECONDARY = Listening
- **Friday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Saturday** · MAIN = L+S combined · SECONDARY = Writing — Discussion

Weekly counts: S = 2 MAIN + 2 SEC + 1 combined + 7 Petra micro = 12; R = 2 MAIN + 1 SEC; L = 1 MAIN + 1 SEC + 1 combined; W = 1 MAIN + 2 SEC. 

4 · Daily checklists (14 days)

Day 1 · Mon 7/27 — Interview 4-mock baseline

Today's focus: Lock in a baseline Interview recording set + AI score before any drilling, so Day 8 / Day 14 have something to measure against.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — 20 new + ~60 reviews from **R-ANKI-1** (<https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/1104981491>), Book 4–6.
- ☐ **0:15–0:25 Petra Interview — R-AI-1** (<https://prepex.ai>) → log in → start a free Interview session → 2 questions, full 45 sec each. Record into phone Voice Memos as D1_Petra_Q1 / D1_Petra_Q2.
- ☐ **0:25–0:40** Shadowing 15 min — pick one TED-Ed video from **R-SHAD-1** (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>). Run the 3-pass protocol.
- ☐ **0:40–1:10 Interview 4-mock — R-OFF-1** TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → log in → Speaking → Interview, 4 questions in a row. Record each as D1_Mock_Q1 . . Q4. Then upload to **R-AI-2** FluentPrep (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>) for full rubric scoring; paste Delivery / Language / Topic numbers into the baseline log below.
- ☐ **1:10–1:30 Writing SECONDARY** — 1 Email task, 10 min timed; copy 2 sentence-level errors into your error log.

Baseline log:

Day 1 Interview Baseline

- Q1 (opinion): Delivery ___ Language ___ Topic ___
- Q2 (memory): Delivery ___ Language ___ Topic ___
- Q3 (lifestyle): ___

- Q4 (hypothetical): ____
 - Most common feedback: _____
-

Day 2 · Tue 7/28 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

Today's focus: Protect Reading depth while keeping the daily Petra Interview floor running.

- ☐ **0:00–0:40** Anki + Petra Interview ×2 (**R-AI-1**, <https://prepex.ai>; save as D2_Petra_Q1/Q2) + 15-min Shadowing (**R-SHAD-1**, <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>).
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Reading MAIN — 1 passage on **R-OFF-1** TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → next unseen passage, timed.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Build a Sentence × 10 on TestReady; log any structure errors.
-

Day 3 · Wed 7/29 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY (Interview deep drill)

Today's focus: First category-focused Interview drill — own the **lifestyle** topic block and its Tie-in segment.

- ☐ **0:00–0:40** Anki + Petra Interview ×2 (D3_Petra_Q1/Q2) + 15-min Shadowing (**R-SHAD-1**, <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>).
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Listening MAIN — **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Listening: 1 lecture + 1 conversation, full note-taking; log every missed detail.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY — Interview deep drill — R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) → request 4 **lifestyle** questions (“how do you usually...”). Record as D3_Lifestyle_Q1..Q4. Focus: Tie-in clarity (30–45 sec); re-listen and mark which answer had the cleanest tie-in.
-

17 Day 4 · Thu 7/30 — W MAIN / R SECONDARY

Today's focus: Writing-heavy day; keep Petra reps non-negotiable to maintain Interview muscle.

- ☐ **0:00–0:40** Anki + Petra Interview ×2 (D4_Petra_Q1/Q2) + 15-min Shadowing (**R-SHAD-1**, <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>).
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Writing MAIN — 1 Discussion task on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>), 10 min timed; save the response to your writing folder.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Reading SECONDARY — either 1 Complete-the-Words on TestReady OR 1 article from **R-REAL-3** Nature News / Science News (<https://www.nature.com/news> · <https://www.sciencenews.org>). Log 5 new lexical items into Anki.
-

17 Day 5 · Fri 7/31 — S MAIN (Interview + L&R refresh) / L SECONDARY

Today's focus: First mixed-category Interview block on the official platform + weekly Listen-and-Repeat preservation drill.

- ☐ **0:00–0:40** Anki + Petra Interview ×2 (D5_Petra_Q1/Q2) + 15-min Shadowing (**R-SHAD-1**, <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>).
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 Speaking MAIN** —
 - 4 Interview questions (mixed categories) on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Speaking → Interview; record as D5_Mock_Q1 . . Q4.
 - + **7-item L&R refresh** on TestReady (keep Ch.4 gain alive); aim for ≥ 80% accuracy and log the score.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Listening SECONDARY — 1 lecture on **R-OFF-1**; log every missed detail into the error log.
-

Day 6 · Sat 8/1 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Reading rep + a light second Petra block to push the week's Interview count past 14.

- ☐ **0:00–0:40** Anki + Petra Interview ×2 (D6_Petra_Q1/Q2) + 15-min Shadowing (**R-SHAD-1**, <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>).
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Reading MAIN — 1 timed passage on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>); record accuracy in your Reading log.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — Petra Interview ×2 (any category) on **R-AI-1** (<https://prepex.ai>); save as D6_PM_Q1/Q2 and log the 1 weakest delivery tic you hear on playback.
-

Day 7 · Sun 8/2 — L+S combined / W secondary

Today's focus: Bridge listening input directly into spontaneous spoken output; close week 1 with a self-review.

- ☐ **0:00–0:40** Anki + Petra Interview ×2 (D7_Petra_Q1/Q2) + 15-min Shadowing (**R-SHAD-1**, <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>).
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 L+S combined** — pick a 10–15 min TED talk from **R-SHAD-2** (<https://www.ted.com/talks>; filter 5–10 min or longer), listen once, then record a 90-sec spoken summary (D7_Summary). Immediately ask **R-AI-1** Petra (<https://prepex.ai>) for 1 Interview question on the same topic; record as D7_TopicQ. Note in the error log: how much did the fresh vocabulary surface in your spontaneous answer?
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — 1 Discussion task on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>), 10 min. Then 5-min weekly mini-review: scan all 7 days of recordings, write 2 lines on what's improving and 1 line on what isn't.
-

17 Day 8 · Mon 8/3 — Interview 4-mock v2 (compare to Day 1)

Today's focus: Mid-chapter checkpoint — measurable delta vs. Day 1 baseline on the same official platform + AI scorer.

- ☐ **0:00–0:40** Anki — continue **R-ANKI-2** Barron's Essential Words for the TOEFL (<https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/973421516>). + Petra Interview ×2 (D8_Petra_Q1/Q2) + 15-min Shadowing (**R-SHAD-1**, <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>).
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10 Interview 4-mock v2** — first re-listen to D1_Mock_Q1..Q4 for 3 min, then **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Speaking → Interview, 4 fresh questions; record as D8_Mock_Q1..Q4. Upload to **R-AI-2** FluentPrep (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>) and paste Delivery / Language / Topic scores beside Day 1 numbers.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — 1 Email task on **R-OFF-1**, 10 min; log errors.
-

17 Day 9 · Tue 8/4 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

Today's focus: Reset into week-2 rhythm; keep Reading volume up while Interview reps continue.

- ☐ **0:00–0:40** Anki (incl. R-ANKI-2) + Petra Interview ×2 (D9_Petra_Q1/Q2) + 15-min Shadowing (**R-SHAD-1**, <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>).
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Reading MAIN — 1 timed passage on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>); log accuracy.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Build a Sentence × 10 on TestReady; log any structure errors.
-

 Day 10 · Wed 8/5 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY (Interview deep drill, opinion only)

Today's focus: Second category-focused drill — drill the **opinion** stance-in-5-sec reflex.

- ☐ **0:00–0:40** Anki + Petra Interview ×2 (D10_Petra_Q1/Q2) + 15-min Shadowing (**R-SHAD-1**, <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>).
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Listening MAIN — **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Listening: 1 lecture + 1 conversation, full notes; log missed details.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY — Interview — R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) → request 4 **opinion** questions (“do you prefer...”). Record as D10_Opinion_Q1..Q4. Focus: clear stance in first 5 sec; mark each playback ✓ / ✕ on that target.
-

 Day 11 · Thu 8/6 — W MAIN / R SECONDARY

Today's focus: Writing depth day; preserve daily Petra count.

- ☐ **0:00–0:40** Anki + Petra Interview ×2 (D11_Petra_Q1/Q2) + 15-min Shadowing (**R-SHAD-1**, <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>).
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Writing MAIN — 1 Discussion task on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>), 10 min timed.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Reading SECONDARY — 1 Complete-the-Words on TestReady; log unknown items into Anki.
-

 Day 12 · Fri 8/7 — S MAIN (Interview + L&R) / L SECONDARY

Today's focus: Second mixed-category Interview block + second weekly L&R preservation check.

- ☐ **0:00–0:40** Anki + Petra Interview ×2 (D12_Petra_Q1/Q2) + 15-min Shadowing (**R-SHAD-1**, <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>).
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Speaking MAIN — 4 Interview questions (mixed categories) on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>); record as D12_Mock_Q1..Q4. Then 7-item L&R refresh on TestReady; log score (target ≥ 80%).
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Listening SECONDARY — 1 lecture on **R-OFF-1**; log missed details.
-

 Day 13 · Sat 8/8 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY (Interview, hypothetical category)

Today's focus: Final category-focused drill — cover **hypothetical** before tomorrow's showcase.

- ☐ **0:00–0:40** Anki + Petra Interview ×2 (D13_Petra_Q1/Q2) + 15-min Shadowing (**R-SHAD-1**, <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>).
 - ☐ **0:40–1:10** Reading MAIN — 1 timed passage on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>); log accuracy.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Speaking SECONDARY — R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) → request 4 **hypothetical** questions (“If you could ... what would you do?”). Record as D13_Hypo_Q1..Q4. In the error log note: did you commit to a single hypothetical or drift between several?
-

 Day 14 · Sun 8/9 — 🎯 Bi-week review + Interview showcase

Today's focus: Closeout — measure the chapter's actual Interview delta, lock the Ch.6 Review Card, and confirm L&R hasn't regressed.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — reviews only, no new cards.
- ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing 15 min (**R-SHAD-1**, <https://ed.ted.com/lessons>).
- ☐ **0:30–1:00 🎯 Interview showcase — R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Speaking → Interview, 4 fresh questions; record as D14_Show_Q1..Q4. Submit to **R-AI-2** FluentPrep (<https://>

www.fluentprep.online/) for full rubric scoring. Paste scores into the Ch.6 Review Card below alongside Day 1 baseline numbers.

- ☐ **1:00–1:30** Fill in the Ch.6 Review Card + run **L&R preservation check** on **R-OFF-1** (7 fresh items; target $\geq 75\%$); record the score in the card.
-

5 · Ch.6 Review Card (Day 14)

Ch.6 Review (8/9)

Showcase Interview results

- Q1 (opinion): Delivery ___ / 4 Language ___ / 4 Topic ___ / 4
- Q2 (memory): ___
- Q3 (lifestyle): ___
- Q4 (hypothetical): ___
- AI Delivery score trend across chapter (Day 1 vs Day 14): ___ → ___

L&R preservation check

- Day 14 L&R: ___ / 7 (target $\geq 75\%$ to confirm no regression)

Goals self-check

- [] G1 Idea/Reason/Tie-in visible in $\geq 80\%$ recordings
- [] G2 4 categories practiced
- [] G3 Delivery score trending up
- [] G4 All answers 40–45 sec
- [] G5 L&R preserved
- [] G6 R/L/W rotation intact

Modification orders for Ch.7 (Writing – Discussion)

- If Interview structure inconsistent → add Idea/Reason/Tie-in template card to Anki
 - If L&R dropped → reintroduce Shadowing 30-min daily in Ch.7
 - If hypothetical category weakest → daily 1 hypothetical Petra question in Ch.7
-

6 · Common pitfalls

1. **The new test penalizes canned answers.** Don't memorize 50 sample answers. Memorize the **structure** (15-15-15 sec).
2. **AI Petra is not ETS — but the gap doesn't matter.** What you're training is fluency volume. 50 Petra reps > 5 perfect ETS-scored attempts.

3. **Time mis-management is the #1 fail.** Practice with a visible timer. Stop talking the second the 45 sec mark hits — train the reflex.
4. **Hesitations are fine; restarts are not.** “Um, well, I think...” is normal speech. “Wait, let me start over” tanks the score. Practice **committing** to whatever answer falls out of your mouth.
5. **Don’t drift back to Independent Speaking templates.** Those are extinct in the new format. The AI scorer flags template-y openings (“In my opinion, the most important factor...”).

Ch.7 · Writing — Academic Discussion (8/10 – 8/23)

Days: 14 (Day 1 = Mon 8/10, Day 14 = Sun 8/23) **Emphasis:** Writing Task 3 — Academic Discussion (200-word forum post in 10 min). **Skill coverage:** Every day touches ≥ 2 skills. Anki + Shadowing floor. **Deliverables:** Discussion 200 words in ≤ 10 min with clear PEEL structure + Milestone 3 (Email ≤ 10 min, Discussion ≤ 10 min on Day 14) + integrated reading–writing connection drilled.

1 · What the Discussion task actually tests

The Academic Discussion task gives a professor’s forum prompt + 2 student posts. You write a **200-word reply** that:

- **Takes a clear position** (agree with student A / B, or third stance)
- **Adds new reasoning** (not just restating either student)
- **Cites or builds on at least one student’s idea** to show engagement
- **Uses academic register** (formal but not stilted; no slang, no contractions)

The AI scorer rewards: **stance clarity, idea novelty, logical structure, and natural academic English.** It penalizes: padding, templates, off-topic riffs, and copying from the prompts.

The PEEL frame (works for any prompt without being a template): - **Point** — your stance, one sentence, in the first 30 sec of writing - **Evidence** — concrete example, study, scenario, or analogy - **Explanation** — why the evidence supports your stance - **Link** — tie back to a student post + close

2 · Chapter goals

- **G1 — Discussion 200 words ≤ 10 min:** reliably (3+ runs in chapter)
 - **G2 — PEEL visible:** all chapter Discussion drafts have all 4 PEEL elements identifiable
 - **G3 — Milestone 3 met:** Email ≤ 10 min AND Discussion ≤ 10 min on Day 14
 - **G4 — Vocabulary level:** AI rubric “Language Use” trending up; ≥ 5 chapter-vocab words used per draft
 - **G5 — Reading–Writing link:** after Reading practice, can paraphrase passage thesis in 1 sentence
 - **G6 — Other skills maintained:** Speaking, Listening rotation intact
-

3 · Modified weekly plan (Discussion emphasis)

Three changes:

1. **Daily 5-min “1-paragraph PEEL drill”** between Anki and Shadowing — pick a random thesis, write one PEEL paragraph (no full 200 words).
2. **Sunday MAIN** = Discussion under strict exam conditions + AI review.
3. **Wednesday MAIN** also Discussion — two structured practice runs per week.

Weekly cadence

- **Sunday** · MAIN = **Writing — Discussion exam-mock** · SECONDARY = Short Listening drill
- **Monday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Writing — Email
- **Tuesday** · MAIN = Listening · SECONDARY = Speaking — Interview
- **Wednesday** · MAIN = **Writing — Discussion** · SECONDARY = Reading
- **Thursday** · MAIN = Speaking · SECONDARY = Listening
- **Friday** · MAIN = Reading · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Saturday** · MAIN = L+S combined · SECONDARY = **Writing — Build a Sentence + Email**

Weekly counts: W = 2 MAIN + 2 SEC + 7 PEEL micro-drills = 11; R = 2 MAIN + 1 SEC; L = 1 MAIN + 2 SEC + 1 combined = 4; S = 1 MAIN + 2 SEC + 1 combined =

4. 

4 · Daily checklists (14 days)

Day 1 · Mon 8/10 — Discussion exam-mock baseline

Today's focus: Establish Discussion baseline draft + AI rubric snapshot for end-of-chapter comparison.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — 20 new + ~60 reviews from current deck (R-ANKI-1 Book 4–6 or R-ANKI-2).
- ☐ **0:15–0:20 PEEL micro-drill** — pick random topic (“Should universities require physical education?”), write one PEEL paragraph (~80 words). 5 min strict.
- ☐ **0:20–0:35** Shadowing 15 min — current phase source (e.g. R-SHAD-2 TED Talks <https://www.ted.com/talks>).
- ☐ **0:35–1:10 Writing MAIN — Discussion exam-mock — R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → log in → Writing section → Academic Discussion. **Strict 10 min** timer. Paste draft into **R-AI-2** FluentPrep (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>) for rubric scores. Save draft as `D1_Discussion_baseline.md`.
- ☐ **1:10–1:30 Listening SECONDARY** — 1 lecture (6 items) on R-OFF-1 TestReady Listening → log missed items in your error log.

Baseline log:

Day 1 Discussion Baseline

- Words written: ____ (target 180–220)
 - Time used: ____ min
 - AI rubric: Task Achievement ____ / Coherence ____ / Language Use ____ / Vocabulary ____
 - PEEL elements present? P ____ E ____ E ____ L ____
-

Day 2 · Tue 8/11 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY (Email)

Today's focus: Drill reading-to-writing transfer by paraphrasing a passage thesis; keep Email muscle warm.

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing

- ☐ **0:35–1:10** Reading MAIN — 1 passage on R-OFF-1 TestReady → Reading section, strict 15 min, + **paraphrase passage thesis** in 1 sentence. Log the paraphrase under D2_thesis_paraphrase.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Email task on R-OFF-1 TestReady → Writing → Email, strict 10 min. Log grammar/register errors.
-

Day 3 · Wed 8/12 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Keep Listening accuracy up and Speaking Interview reflex sharp.

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Listening MAIN — 1 lecture + 1 conversation on R-OFF-1 TestReady → Listening. Aim ≥ 80% accuracy; log every miss.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — **R-AI-1** PrepEx/Petra (<https://prepex.ai>) → Interview task × 2. Record + log filler-word count and any rubric feedback.
-

Day 4 · Thu 8/13 — W MAIN (Discussion v2) / R SECONDARY

Today's focus: Stance clarity in the opening sentence — make P of PEEL unmistakable in the first 30 seconds.

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Writing MAIN — **Discussion v2** on R-OFF-1 TestReady → Writing → Academic Discussion, strict 10 min. Score in **R-AI-2** FluentPrep (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>); read AI feedback specifically on “Topic Development / Task Achievement.” Save as D4_Discussion_v2.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Reading SECONDARY — Complete-the-Words on R-OFF-1 TestReady OR read 1 **R-REAL-3** Nature/Science News article (<https://www.nature.com/news> · <https://www.sciencenews.org>) and log 5 unknown words to Anki.
-

17 Day 5 · Fri 8/14 — S MAIN / L SECONDARY

Today's focus: Speaking volume day — pronunciation reps (L&R) + Interview fluency.

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Speaking MAIN — Listen & Repeat × 7 on R-OFF-1 TestReady → Speaking → Listen & Repeat, then Interview × 2 on **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>). Record into phone Voice Memos, save as D5_Speaking.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Listening SECONDARY — 1 lecture on R-OFF-1 TestReady → Listening; log misses.
-

17 Day 6 · Sat 8/15 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Cross-skill bridge — turn a Reading passage into a Discussion-style PEEL stance.

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Reading MAIN — 1 passage on R-OFF-1 TestReady → Reading. Today: read passage **first**, then write a 1-paragraph PEEL stance (~80 words, 5 min) on the passage's central claim instead of doing the standard items. Save as D6_PEEL_from_reading.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) → Interview × 2. Log filler-word count + 1 phrasing fix.
-

17 Day 7 · Sun 8/16 — L+S combined / W secondary (Build + Email)

Today's focus: Long-form listen-then-speak integration + lightweight Writing maintenance to close week 1.

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing

- ☐ **0:35–1:10** L+S combined — pick a **R-SHAD-2** TED Talk 10–15 min (<https://www.ted.com/talks>, filter 5–15 min). Watch once, take 5 bullet notes, then record a 90-sec spoken summary into Voice Memos as D7_LS_summary.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Build a Sentence × 5 on R-OFF-1 TestReady → Writing → Build a Sentence + outline 1 Email (no full draft). Weekly mini-review: scan Days 1–6 error log, mark top recurring error.
-

Day 8 · Mon 8/17 — Discussion mock v3 (compare to Day 1)

Today's focus: Mid-chapter Discussion benchmark — quantify progress vs. Day 1 baseline.

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10 Discussion mock v3** on R-OFF-1 TestReady → Writing → Academic Discussion, strict 10 min. Re-read D1_Discussion_baseline.md first, then go. Score in **R-AI-2** FluentPrep (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>). Paste both rubric scorecards into a side-by-side table; note movement per rubric line.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Listening SECONDARY — 1 lecture on R-OFF-1 TestReady → Listening; error log.
-

Day 9 · Tue 8/18 — R MAIN / W SECONDARY

Today's focus: Reading accuracy + Email speed maintenance going into week 2.

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Reading MAIN — 1 passage on R-OFF-1 TestReady → Reading, strict 15 min. Aim ≥ 80% accuracy; paraphrase thesis in 1 sentence.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Email on R-OFF-1 TestReady → Writing → Email, strict 10 min. Log register/grammar errors.
-

17 Day 10 · Wed 8/19 — L MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Listening accuracy block + Interview reflex reps.

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Listening MAIN — 1 lecture + 1 conversation on R-OFF-1 TestReady → Listening. Aim ≥ 80% accuracy; log every miss.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) → Interview × 2. Log filler count + 1 corrected phrasing.
-

17 Day 11 · Thu 8/20 — W MAIN (Discussion v4) / R SECONDARY

Today's focus: Third-stance Discussion — break the “pick A or B” reflex and produce original synthesis.

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10 Discussion v4** on R-OFF-1 TestReady → Writing → Academic Discussion, strict 10 min. Today: **third-stance** — don't agree with student A or B, propose a synthesis. Score in **R-AI-2** FluentPrep (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>); save as D11_Discussion_v4_thirdstance.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Reading SECONDARY — Complete-the-Words on R-OFF-1 TestReady → Reading; log unknown stems to Anki.
-

17 Day 12 · Fri 8/21 — S MAIN / L SECONDARY

Today's focus: Speaking high-volume day — Interview reps + pronunciation refresh.

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
- ☐ **0:35–1:10** Speaking MAIN — **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) → Interview × 4, then 7 Listen & Repeat items on R-OFF-1 TestReady → Speaking → Listen & Repeat. Record into Voice Memos as D12_Speaking.

- ☐ **1:10–1:30** Listening SECONDARY — 1 lecture on R-OFF-1 TestReady → Listening; error log.
-

 Day 13 · Sat 8/22 — R MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Final tune-up before Milestone 3 — keep Reading + Speaking warm without burning energy.

- ☐ Anki + PEEL drill + Shadowing
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Reading MAIN — 1 passage on R-OFF-1 TestReady → Reading, strict 15 min. Paraphrase thesis in 1 sentence.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) → Interview × 2. Log filler count.
-

 Day 14 · Sun 8/23 — 🎯 Milestone 3 + Bi-week review

Today's focus: Prove both Writing tasks fit under exam time, then close out Ch.7 with the review card.

Milestone 3: Both Writing tasks under exam time.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki + reviews — clear any due backlog.
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing — 15 min on current source.
 - ☐ **0:30–0:45** 🎯 **Email mock** — R-OFF-1 TestReady → Writing → Email, strict 10 min. Target: ≤ 10 min, ~100 words. Log final word count + time.
 - ☐ **0:45–1:00** 🎯 **Discussion mock** — R-OFF-1 TestReady → Writing → Academic Discussion, strict 10 min. Target: ≤ 10 min, 180–220 words, all 4 PEEL elements visible. Score in **R-AI-2** FluentPrep (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>) and record results in the Review Card below.
 - ☐ **1:00–1:30** Ch.7 Review Card — fill out the template in § 5 below.
-

5 · Ch.7 Review Card (Day 14)

Ch.7 Review (8/23) – Milestone 3

Milestone 3 results

- Email: __ words in __ min – ****PASS**** (≤ 10 min, ~100 words) / ****HOLD**** / ****REDO****
- Discussion: __ words in __ min – ****PASS**** (≤ 10 min, 180–220 words, PEEL visible) / ****HOLD**** / ****REDO****

Goals self-check

- [] G1 Discussion 200 words ≤ 10 min (3+ runs)
- [] G2 PEEL visible in all drafts
- [] G3 Milestone 3 met
- [] G4 Language Use score trending up
- [] G5 Can paraphrase passage thesis in 1 sentence
- [] G6 Speaking/Listening rotation maintained

Writing diagnostic

- Strongest of 3 tasks (Email / Build-a-Sentence / Discussion):

- Weakest: _____ – root cause: _____
- AI rubric area most often flagged across chapter: _____

Modification orders for Ch.8 (Adaptive Module 1 mastery)

- If Milestone 3 REDO on either task → add 1 Email or Discussion micro-mock per Ch.8 week
- If PEEL inconsistent → write 2 PEEL frames daily in Ch.8 (1 minute each, in Anki)
- If language use lagging → focus Anki on ****academic phrase bank**** instead of new vocab

6 · Common pitfalls

1. **200 words is not aspirational — it's the contract.** Under 180 → underweight. Over 230 → wasting time on a clock you don't have.
2. **Don't restate the prompt.** AI penalizes copy-paste. Paraphrase or skip the restatement.
3. **PEEL is a frame, not a template.** Don't write "My point is X. My evidence is Y. My explanation is Z. My link is W." Write **as if having a real opinion** — but cover all 4 functions.

4. **Cite a student post** by name or paraphrase: “Building on Sarah’s point about ____.” This single move bumps Task Achievement scores reliably.
5. **Read aloud during the 30-sec re-read window.** Hearing your sentence catches errors your eye misses. (You can mouth silently in the test.)
6. **Don’t over-vocabulary.** A perfect simple sentence beats a clumsy showy one. AI rubric punishes misused fancy words harder than absent ones.

Ch.8 · Adaptive Realism — Module 1 Mastery (8/24 – 9/6)

Days: 14 (Day 1 = Mon 8/24, Day 14 = Sun 9/6) **Emphasis:** Module 1 accuracy across all 4 skills (with Listening/Reading getting most adaptive-specific drilling, since those are the only truly adaptive sections). **Skill coverage:** Every day touches ≥ 2 skills. Anki + Shadowing floor. **Deliverables:** Module 1 accuracy targets met on **every** skill area + careless-error rate cut by $\geq 50\%$ vs Ch.1 baseline + transition from “skill building” to “test performance” mindset.

1 · Why Module 1 is the score lever

The 2026 adaptive engine works like this:

1. You start Module 1 (mid-difficulty items).
2. The engine measures your accuracy on Module 1.
3. If you do well, Module 2 unlocks at **higher difficulty** — your score ceiling rises.
4. If you stumble in Module 1, Module 2 stays at lower difficulty — your ceiling caps.

Consequence: a “silly mistake” in Module 1 hurts more than an outright wrong answer in Module 2. The engine reads Module 1 stumbles as “this person doesn’t have mastery” → caps the ceiling.

This chapter rewires your practice toward **single-pass accuracy under exam conditions** — not “did I learn this concept” but “did I get it right the first time, under time, when it counted.”

2 · Chapter goals

- **G1 — Reading Module 1 accuracy:** $\geq 90\%$ on 3 separate fresh sets
 - **G2 — Listening Module 1 accuracy:** $\geq 85\%$ on 3 separate fresh sets
 - **G3 — Speaking L&R accuracy:** $\geq 85\%$ exact-match on 3 separate sets
 - **G4 — Writing Email + Discussion:** each completed in ≤ 9 min (1 min buffer below ceiling)
 - **G5 — Careless-error rate:** tagged “careless” errors $\leq 50\%$ of Ch.1 baseline
 - **G6 — Speed-accuracy decoupling:** can verbally explain when to slow down vs press on
-

3 · Modified weekly plan (Module 1 emphasis across all skills)

Three changes:

1. Every MAIN block is “Module 1 only” — not full sections. Quality over volume.
2. **Daily 5-min “careless-error review”** between Anki and Shadowing — re-read yesterday’s tagged careless errors aloud, articulate the trap.
3. **Sunday MAIN** = mini-full mock (1 R Module 1 + 1 L Module 1 + 1 Email, all back-to-back, simulating fatigue stack).

Weekly cadence

- **Sunday** · MAIN = **Mini-full mock** (R-M1 + L-M1 + Email) · SECONDARY = Discussion
- **Monday** · MAIN = **Reading Module 1** · SECONDARY = **Writing Build-a-Sentence**
- **Tuesday** · MAIN = **Listening Module 1** · SECONDARY = Speaking — Interview
- **Wednesday** · MAIN = **Writing Discussion** · SECONDARY = Reading Module 1 (timed accuracy drill)
- **Thursday** · MAIN = **Speaking L&R + Interview** · SECONDARY = Listening Module 1
- **Friday** · MAIN = **Reading Module 1** · SECONDARY = Speaking
- **Saturday** · MAIN = L+S combined (real material) · SECONDARY = **Writing — Email**

Weekly counts: R = 3 MAIN + 1 SEC; L = 2 MAIN + 1 SEC + 1 combined; W = 2 MAIN + 2 SEC; S = 1 MAIN + 2 SEC + 1 combined. 

4 · Daily checklists (14 days)

Day 1 · Mon 8/24 — Mini-full mock (fatigue-stack baseline)

Today's focus: Establish a Ch.8 fatigue-stacked baseline across R+L+W
Module 1 work so every later day has something to beat.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — open desktop/AnkiDroid (**R-ANKI-4** <https://apps.ankiweb.net/>), clear today's due queue from **R-ANKI-1** (<https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/1104981491>) Book 4–6 + **R-ANKI-2** (<https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/973421516>)
- ☐ **0:15–0:20 Careless-error review** — open your error log, re-read your 3 most recent “careless” tagged errors aloud, articulate in one sentence what you'll do differently next time
- ☐ **0:20–0:35** Shadowing 15 min — pick today's clip from **R-SHAD-2** (<https://www.ted.com/talks>) filtered 5–10 min, apply the 3-pass protocol
- ☐ **0:35–1:20 Mini-full mock** (45 min block) — log in to **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>), run back-to-back with **no breaks**:
 - 1 Reading Module 1 set (10 items, 18 min strict — use a phone timer)
 - 1 Listening Module 1 set (10 items, ~15 min)
 - 1 Email task (10 min strict)
- ☐ **1:20–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Discussion task on **R-OFF-1**, 10 min strict; paste response into **R-AI-2** FluentPrep (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>) for rubric scoring; log every error tagged careless/knowledge/timing

Baseline log:

Day 1 Mini-mock Baseline

- Reading M1: ___ / ___ → %: ___
 - Listening M1: ___ / ___ → %: ___
 - Email AI rubric overall: ___
 - Felt: how was fatigue by the Email task? ___
-

17 Day 2 · Tue 8/25 — R-M1 MAIN / W SECONDARY

Today's focus: First clean Reading Module 1 attempt of the chapter — aim for the 90% accuracy bar and tag every miss.

- ☐ **0:00–0:35** Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing (15 min from **R-SHAD-2** <https://www.ted.com/talks>)
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10 Reading Module 1 MAIN** — on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Reading → pick a fresh Module 1 set, strict 18 min timer. Goal: **single-pass accuracy** ≥ 90%. Score immediately, then tag every error as careless / vocab / inference / time-pressure in the error log.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Build a Sentence × 10 on **R-OFF-1** Writing drills + log any grammar misses
-

17 Day 3 · Wed 8/26 — L-M1 MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: First clean Listening Module 1 attempt — hit ≥ 85% and identify whether misses are note-taking or recall failures.

- ☐ **0:00–0:35** Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing (15 min)
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10 Listening Module 1 MAIN** — on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Listening → fresh Module 1 set (1 lecture + 1 conversation), headphones on, no pausing. Goal: ≥ 85%. After scoring, replay each missed item and mark in error log whether you mis-heard, mis-noted, or forgot.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — open **R-AI-1** PrepEx / Petra (<https://prepex.ai>), run 2 Interview-task prompts, record into the tool, save the AI feedback, log weak phrases
-

Day 4 · Thu 8/27 — Discussion MAIN / R-M1 SECONDARY

Today's focus: Lock Discussion-task timing under 9 min while keeping rubric quality, plus a low-pressure accuracy-only Reading drill.

- ☐ **0:00–0:35** Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing (15 min)
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10 Writing MAIN — Discussion** — fresh prompt on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>), strict 10 min timer, target finish ≤ 9 min. Paste into **R-AI-2** FluentPrep (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>) for rubric scoring; record finish time + word count.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Reading Module 1 SECONDARY** — 5-item drill from **R-OFF-1** (or **R-FREE-3** https://testsucceed.com/materials/tests/toefl_new if you've burned the TestReady set), **no timer** — focus purely on accuracy + reasoning, log every miss
-

Day 5 · Fri 8/28 — Speaking L&R + Interview MAIN / L-M1 SECONDARY

Today's focus: High-volume Speaking session — push L&R exact-match toward 85% and stress-test Interview fluency under rubric scoring.

- ☐ **0:00–0:35** Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing (15 min)
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10 Speaking MAIN** — 7 Listen & Repeat items + 4 Interview items from **R-OFF-1** Speaking (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>). Record each into phone Voice Memos saved as D5_LR_## / D5_Int_##, then upload to **R-AI-2** FluentPrep (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>) for ETS-rubric scoring. Log L&R exact-match % and Interview overall.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Listening Module 1 SECONDARY** — 1 conversation (5 items) on **R-OFF-1**, score and log misses
-

Day 6 · Sat 8/29 — R-M1 MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Second clean Reading Module 1 rep of the week — confirm the Day 2 result wasn't a fluke.

- ☐ **0:00–0:35** Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing (15 min)
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Reading Module 1 MAIN — new fresh set on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>), strict 18 min. Score, log, compare % vs Day 2.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) Interview × 2, record + capture AI feedback in error log
-

Day 7 · Sun 8/30 — L+S combined / W secondary (Email)

Today's focus: Real-world lecture-to-speech rep that mirrors test cognitive load, then a fast Email under timer.

- ☐ **0:00–0:35** Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing (15 min)
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** L+S combined — pick one 10-min lecture clip from **R-REAL-4** MIT OpenCourseWare (<https://ocw.mit.edu/>), take Cornell-style notes while listening, then deliver a 90-sec spoken summary into phone Voice Memos saved as D7_Summary. Self-grade: did you cover thesis + 2 supporting points + 1 example?
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Email task on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>), 10 min strict, score via **R-AI-2** (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>). Then 5-min weekly mini-review: scan error log, note 1 pattern
-

Day 8 · Mon 8/31 — Mini-full mock v2 (compare to Day 1)

Today's focus: Repeat the Day 1 stack with fresh sets so you have a like-for-like before/after to judge the week's gains.

- ☐ **0:00–0:35** Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing (15 min)

- ☐ **0:35–1:20 Mini-full mock v2** (45 min block) — same stack as Day 1 on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>), all fresh sets, no breaks: R-M1 (18 min) + L-M1 (~15 min) + Email (10 min). After scoring, write 2-line diff vs Day 1: which skill moved most? where did fatigue still bite?
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Discussion 10 min on **R-OFF-1** → score in **R-AI-2** (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>) + log errors
-

Day 9 · Tue 9/1 — R-M1 MAIN / W SECONDARY

Today's focus: Third counted Reading Module 1 rep — this is one of the 3 fresh sets that have to clear G1's 90%.

- ☐ **0:00–0:35** Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing (15 min)
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Reading Module 1 MAIN — fresh set on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>), strict 18 min. Log %; mark in tracker as the 3rd of the G1 “≥ 90% on 3 separate fresh sets” set if it clears.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Writing SECONDARY — Build a Sentence × 10 on **R-OFF-1** Writing drills + log any grammar misses
-

Day 10 · Wed 9/2 — L-M1 MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Second fresh Listening Module 1 of the chapter — confirm ≥ 85% stays repeatable.

- ☐ **0:00–0:35** Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing (15 min)
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Listening Module 1 MAIN — fresh set on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>), headphones, no pausing. Log %; replay misses and tag note-taking vs recall.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) Interview × 2 + error log
-

17 Day 11 · Thu 9/3 — Discussion MAIN / R-M1 SECONDARY

Today's focus: Second Discussion rep with the ≤ 9 min ceiling — make sub-9 the norm, not the exception.

- ☐ **0:00–0:35** Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing (15 min)
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Discussion MAIN — fresh prompt on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>), 10 min strict, target finish ≤ 9 min. Score in **R-AI-2** (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>); log finish time + rubric.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Reading Module 1 SEC — 5-item accuracy drill (no timer) on **R-OFF-1** or **R-FREE-3** (https://testsucceed.com/materials/tests/toefl_new) + error log
-

17 Day 12 · Fri 9/4 — Speaking MAIN / L-M1 SECONDARY

Today's focus: Second high-volume Speaking session — push L&R closer to the G3 $\geq 85\%$ bar.

- ☐ **0:00–0:35** Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing (15 min)
 - ☐ **0:35–1:10** Speaking MAIN — 7 L&R + 4 Interview from **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>). Record into Voice Memos as D12_LR_## / D12_Int_##, score via **R-AI-2** (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>). Compare L&R % vs Day 5.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Listening Module 1 SEC — 1 conversation (5 items) on **R-OFF-1** + error log
-

17 Day 13 · Sat 9/5 — R-M1 MAIN / S SECONDARY

Today's focus: Final Reading Module 1 dress rehearsal before tomorrow's showcase — lock the 18-min pacing.

- ☐ **0:00–0:35** Anki + Careless-error review + Shadowing (15 min)

- ☐ **0:35–1:10** Reading Module 1 MAIN — fresh set on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>), strict 18 min, score and log.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Speaking SECONDARY — **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) Interview × 2 + error log
-

Day 14 · Sun 9/6 — 🎯 Module 1 showcase across 4 skills + Bi-week review

Today's focus: Stack all 4 skills back-to-back at Module 1 difficulty to verify chapter goals G1–G4 before Ch.9 mocks begin.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki + reviews — clear today's queue across **R-ANKI-1** (<https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/1104981491>) + **R-ANKI-2** (<https://ankiweb.net/shared/info/973421516>)
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing 15 min (3-pass) from **R-SHAD-2** (<https://www.ted.com/talks>)
 - ☐ **0:30–1:15** 🎯 **Module 1 showcase** — on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>), no breaks, all fresh sets: R-M1 (18 min) → L-M1 (~15 min) → 7-item L&R (record as D14_LR_##, score via **R-AI-2** <https://www.fluentprep.online/>) → 1 Email (10 min). Drop all results into the Review Card below.
 - ☐ **1:15–1:30** Fill in the Ch.8 Review Card and decide PASS/HOLD/REDO per goal
-

5 · Ch.8 Review Card (Day 14)

Ch.8 Review (9/6)

Module 1 showcase results

- Reading M1: ___ / 10 → %: ___ → PASS (≥ 90%) / HOLD / REDO
- Listening M1: ___ / 10 → %: ___ → PASS (≥ 85%) / HOLD / REDO
- L&R: ___ / 7 → %: ___ → PASS (≥ 85%) / HOLD / REDO
- Email: ___ min, ___ words, AI rubric overall ___

Careless-error rate

- Ch.1 baseline careless errors: ___

- Ch.8 careless errors this 14-day stretch: ____
- Reduction: ____% (*target ≥ 50% reduction*)

Goals self-check

- [] G1 R-M1 ≥ 90% on 3+ separate fresh sets
- [] G2 L-M1 ≥ 85% on 3+ separate fresh sets
- [] G3 L&R ≥ 85% on 3+ separate sets
- [] G4 Email & Discussion ≤ 9 min reliably
- [] G5 Careless rate halved vs Ch.1
- [] G6 Can articulate slow-down vs press-on heuristic

Modification orders for Ch.9 (Full mocks)

- If any Module 1 still RED0 → add 1 R-M1 or L-M1 drill per Ch.9 week
 - If careless rate stuck → start every Ch.9 mock with a 60-sec "deliberate slow-start" warm-up
 - If Email/Discussion timing still >10 min → micro-drill 1 task daily on top of Ch.9 mocks
-

6 · Common pitfalls

1. **Don't speed up Module 1.** The engine doesn't care if you finish 30 seconds early. It cares about accuracy. Allocate generously, then re-check before submitting.
2. **Careless errors come in clusters.** When you misread one item, you're often in a low-attention state — the next 2–3 items are at risk too. Build a habit of taking a 5-sec micro-reset after every error you catch.
3. **Time is a tool, not a goal.** Don't say "I finished R-M1 in 14 min so I'm great." Say "I got 9/10 in 16 min so I'm great." Speed only matters if accuracy is locked.
4. **AI scoring is noisier than it looks.** Compare 3 attempts before trusting a trend. A single bad score doesn't mean regression.
5. **Don't burn out before Ch.9.** Ch.9 is full mocks ×4 — high-energy. If Ch.8 leaves you drained, you'll bomb Ch.9. Pace, hydrate, sleep.

Ch.9 · Full Mocks ×4 + Error Attribution (9/7 – 9/20)

Days: 14 (Day 1 = Mon 9/7, Day 14 = Sun 9/20) **Emphasis:** Whole-test execution under real conditions; turning practice into score. **Skill coverage:**

Mocks are inherently all-4-skill. Anki + Shadowing floor. **Deliverables: 4 full mocks** completed with score trend visible, stabilizing at ≥ 100 (target band) by Day 14 + thorough error-attribution log + exam-day routine rehearsed.

1 · The Ch.9 rhythm

This is the chapter where you stop “studying TOEFL” and start “executing TOEFL.”

Each mock cycle = 3 days: - **Mock Day:** 90 minutes, full simulation (single 90-min block, no phone, no music) - **Attribution Day:** the entire 90 minutes is spent **on the mock’s errors** — not new practice - **Active recovery + targeted drill Day:** light Anki + Shadowing + 1 quick drill on the weakest skill the mock exposed

You do this 4 times ($3 \times 4 = 12$ days) — with **Day 7 inserted as a deliberate light/taper day** between cycles 2 and 3 — leaving Day 14 for the Bi-week review + exam-day dress rehearsal.

Mock source plan (all free — \$0 total)

- **Mock 1** → **R-FREE-1** Magoosh free 2026 practice test (<https://magoosh.com/toefl/toefl-practice-test/>)
 - *Why this one here:* Full sections, free signup, fresh content. Calibrate yourself before the higher-stakes mocks.
- **Mock 2** → **R-FREE-3** TestSucceed 2026 sample materials (https://testsucceed.com/materials/tests/toefl_new)
 - *Why this one here:* Has examples for every new task type — broad coverage.
- **Mock 3** → **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady free-tier full mock (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>)
 - *Why this one here:* Official scoring engine. **This is the one where you must hit ≥ 100 .** Use whatever full adaptive mock is included in your TestReady free tier.
- **Mock 4** → **R-OFF-2** ETS Sample Test Jan 2026 (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/sample-test-jan-2026-1.html>) (retake)
 - *Why this one here:* Most format-accurate free option. You did this in Ch.1 — 4 months later you’ve forgotten enough that the retake is honest. Compare scaled score to your Day 2–3 baseline = headline progress number.

Why mix sources? Same-source repetition trains you on that source's quirks (item style, scoring tendency), not the test itself. Mixing forces generalization — closer to real-exam behavior.

The “I want one more official mock” trap. If after Mock 4 you feel you need another full retired official test, the only true option is **R-OFF-5** TPO (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/practice-tests.html>) (\$45.95/volume). It is **optional and last-resort**. Don't buy it preemptively at Day 1 — only consider it if (a) you've actually finished all 4 mocks above and (b) Mock 4 was within 3 points of Mock 3 but below 100 and you want one more calibrated rep before exam day. Most people don't need it.

2 · Chapter goals

- **G1 — 4 full mocks completed:** all 4 done, all 4 scored
 - **G2 — Stable mock score ≥ 100 :** Mocks 3 & 4 both ≥ 100 (or your target band)
 - **G3 — Error attribution:** every wrong item in every mock has cause + planned fix
 - **G4 — Exam-day routine:** a reproducible morning + transit + warm-up routine, tested
 - **G5 — Time control:** all 4 mocks completed without running over total time
 - **G6 — Stamina:** Mock 4 score within 3 points of Mock 3 (no late-mock fatigue dip)
-

3 · Mock-cycle schedule

- **Day 1 · Mon 9/7 — Mock 1** (90 min) + brief immediate score
- **Day 2 · Tue 9/8 — Attribution 1** (90 min, every error analyzed)
- **Day 3 · Wed 9/9 — Recovery + targeted drill** on Mock 1 weakest skill
- **Day 4 · Thu 9/10 — Mock 2**
- **Day 5 · Fri 9/11 — Attribution 2**
- **Day 6 · Sat 9/12 — Recovery + targeted drill**
- **Day 7 · Sun 9/13 — Light day — Anki + Shadowing + 1 Petra Interview round** (no full mock)
- **Day 8 · Mon 9/14 — Mock 3**
- **Day 9 · Tue 9/15 — Attribution 3**
- **Day 10 · Wed 9/16 — Recovery + targeted drill**

- **Day 11 · Thu 9/17 — Mock 4**
- **Day 12 · Fri 9/18 — Attribution 4**
- **Day 13 · Sat 9/19 — Recovery + targeted drill**
- **Day 14 · Sun 9/20 — Bi-week review + exam-day routine dress rehearsal**

All four skills are touched on every Mock Day (mock is whole-test). On Attribution and Recovery days, Anki + Shadowing maintain the L+S+vocab floor. Targeted drills rotate by chapter weakness.

4 · Daily checklists (14 days)

Day 1 · Mon 9/7 — Mock 1

Today's focus: First calibration mock — establish a baseline number and feel the full 90-minute load before the higher-stakes mocks.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki (~20 new + 60 reviews) + 5-min Shadowing warm-up (don't skip — these mocks happen in the same morning slot as the real exam)
- ☐ **0:15–1:45** 🎯 **Mock 1 — R-FREE-1** Magoosh free 2026 practice test (<https://magoosh.com/toefl/toefl-practice-test/>) — sign in → start the full 2026 practice test → run all sections back-to-back. 90 min, single sitting. **Treat as exam:**
 - Same time of day as real exam (~08:00 if you can)
 - No phone, no snacks mid-mock
 - Use scratch paper for notes
 - Stop immediately at the timer
- ☐ **Score block (post-90min):** Record scores immediately while fresh into your error log under Mock 1 (9/7):

Mock 1 (9/7)

- Reading: __ / 30 (M1: __ / __, M2: __ / __)
- Listening: __ / 30 (M1: __ / __, M2: __ / __)
- Speaking: __ / 30 (L&R: __ / 7, Interview Delivery+Lang+Topic)
- Writing: __ / 30 (Build: __, Email: __, Discussion: __)
- Total: __ / 120
- CEFR band: __

- Felt energy at minute 45: ____ / 10
 - Felt energy at minute 90: ____ / 10
-

Day 2 · Tue 9/8 — Attribution 1

Today's focus: Convert Mock 1 errors into concrete habit changes — diagnosis day, not practice day.

Today: no new mock items. Whole 90 min on Mock 1 errors.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki + Shadowing 15 min
- ☐ **0:30–1:30 Attribution session.** Reopen the Mock 1 review screen alongside your error log. For every wrong item, tag the cause:
 - Reading: which question type? Vocab / inference / detail / paragraph purpose / negative-fact / sentence-insert?
 - Listening: vocab / speed / inattention / accent / lost the structure?
 - Speaking: delivery / language / topic? Which task?
 - Writing: AI rubric tells you — note which rubric area was weakest.
- ☐ By end of session, fill in below in the error log:

Mock 1 Attribution

- Weakest skill: _____
 - Most common error cause across skills: _____
 - 3 specific habit changes for Mock 2:
 1. _____
 2. _____
 3. _____
-

Day 3 · Wed 9/9 — Recovery + targeted drill

Today's focus: Light, targeted rep on Mock 1's weakest skill so the fix lands before Mock 2.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki (20 new + 60 reviews)
- ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing — 3-pass protocol on one short clip

- ☐ **0:30–1:10 Targeted drill on Mock 1 weakest skill** — 1 set of that skill's Module 1 only (or 7 L&R items / 1 Email + Discussion) from **R-OFF-1** TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) free tier. Apply the 3 habit changes from yesterday; aim for $\geq 80\%$ Module 1 accuracy.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 Light Anki review + error log** — note today's drill score next to the Mock 1 entry
-

Day 4 · Thu 9/10 — Mock 2

Today's focus: Second mock under exam conditions — verify the Day 2 habit changes actually fire.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki + 5-min Shadowing warm-up
 - ☐ **0:15–1:45** 🎯 **Mock 2 — R-FREE-3** TestSucceed 2026 sample materials (https://testsucceed.com/materials/tests/toefl_new) — open the 2026 sample test page and run R / L / S / W back-to-back. Same conditions as Mock 1 (same time of day, no phone, scratch paper). **Did the 3 habit changes show up?**
 - ☐ Score block (same template as Day 1, label Mock 2 (9/10)) — log in error log immediately
-

Day 5 · Fri 9/11 — Attribution 2

Today's focus: Diff Mock 2 vs Mock 1 — confirm what closed and surface what's new.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki + Shadowing (15 min)
 - ☐ **0:30–1:30 Attribution session.** Open Mock 2 review side-by-side with the Mock 1 attribution notes. Tag every wrong item by cause (same taxonomy as Day 2). Then compare to Mock 1: which weakness is resolved? Which is new?
 - ☐ **3 habit changes for Mock 3** (write into error log):
 - 1.
 - 2.
 - 3.
-

17 Day 6 · Sat 9/12 — Recovery + targeted drill

Today's focus: Targeted rep on Mock 2's weakest skill; protect the body for the Day 7 taper.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki (20 new + 60 reviews) + Shadowing (3-pass on one short clip)
 - ☐ **0:30–1:10** Drill weakest skill from Mock 2 — 1 Module 1 set (or skill-equivalent) on **R-OFF-1** TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) free tier. Apply the 3 Mock-3 habit changes; aim for $\geq 80\%$.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Error log — note drill accuracy + any new error patterns under the Mock 2 entry
-

17 Day 7 · Sun 9/13 — Light day

Today's focus: Deliberate taper — cumulative fatigue is what tanks Mocks 3–4, so protect the system today.

Real exams happen with **rest days before them**. Don't grind through Sat.

- ☐ Anki — full session (20 new + 60 reviews), this is the easy part
 - ☐ Shadowing 15 min (3-pass on one short clip, easy source like **R-SHAD-4** BBC 6 Minute English (<https://www.bbc.co.uk/learningenglish/english/features/6-minute-english>) if burnt out)
 - ☐ Petra Interview $\times 2$ on **R-AI-1** PrepEx (<https://prepex.ai>) — keep speaking warm; record outputs as D7_Interview_1 and D7_Interview_2
 - ☐ **No mocks, no full sections.** Walk, sleep, hydrate.
-

17 Day 8 · Mon 9/14 — Mock 3

Today's focus: The credibility mock — official ETS scoring engine, this is where you must hit ≥ 100 .

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki + 5-min Shadowing warm-up

- ☐ **0:15–1:45** 🎯 **Mock 3 — R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady free-tier full mock (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) — log in → launch the full adaptive mock included in the free tier → run all 4 sections back-to-back. Official scoring engine. **Target ≥ 100.** This is the most credible score in the 4-mock sequence.
 - ☐ Score block (template from Day 1, label Mock 3 (9/14)) — log immediately
-

Day 9 · Tue 9/15 — Attribution 3

Today's focus: Decode the official-scored mock — name the systematic gap (if any) before Mock 4.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki + Shadowing (15 min)
 - ☐ **0:30–1:30 Attribution session** on Mock 3 (same taxonomy as Day 2). **Did you hit ≥ 100?** If yes, what stabilized? If no, what's the systematic gap?
 - ☐ **3 habit changes for Mock 4** (and the real exam) — write into error log:
 - 1.
 - 2.
 - 3.
-

Day 10 · Wed 9/16 — Recovery + targeted drill

Today's focus: Last meaningful drill window before Mock 4 — fix the Mock 3 systematic gap.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki (20 new + 60 reviews) + Shadowing (3-pass on one short clip)
 - ☐ **0:30–1:10** Drill weakest skill from Mock 3 — 1 Module 1 set (or equivalent) on **R-OFF-1** TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) free tier; apply the 3 Mock-4 habit changes; aim for ≥80%
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Error log — note drill accuracy under Mock 3 entry
-

Day 11 · Thu 9/17 — Mock 4

Today's focus: Stability + headline-progress mock — retake the Ch.1 baseline test, compare directly.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki + 5-min Shadowing warm-up
 - ☐ **0:15–1:45** 🎯 **Mock 4 — R-OFF-2** ETS Sample Test Jan 2026 (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/sample-test-jan-2026-1.html>) (the one you did in Ch.1 as baseline; you've forgotten enough after 4 months) — open the sample test page → run all 4 sections back-to-back under exam conditions. **Target ≥ 100 AND within 3 points of Mock 3** (= stability). **Also compare scaled score directly to your Day 2–3 baseline — this is your headline progress number.**
 - ☐ Score block (template from Day 1, label Mock 4 (9/17)) — log immediately; in the same entry record the delta vs Ch.1 baseline and vs Mock 3
-

Day 12 · Fri 9/18 — Attribution 4

Today's focus: Final stable-state read — classify residual errors as systematic vs random to set Ch.10's drill target.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki + Shadowing (15 min)
 - ☐ **0:30–1:30 Attribution session** on Mock 4 (same taxonomy as Day 2). Final stable-state assessment. **Are the remaining errors systematic or random?** Random = ready. Systematic = one more drill target for Ch.10 (Final Week) — write that target into the Ch.9 Review Card “Residual systematic errors” slot.
-

Day 13 · Sat 9/19 — Recovery + targeted drill

Today's focus: Taper drill + draft the exam-day routine doc you'll dress-rehearse tomorrow.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki (20 new + 60 reviews) + Shadowing (3-pass on one short clip)

- ☐ **0:30–1:10** Final drill on Mock 4 weakest skill — 1 Module 1 set (or equivalent) on **R-OFF-1** TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) free tier. Keep it light, this is taper — no over-drilling.
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30** Error log + start drafting your exam-day routine doc (wake time, breakfast, transit, on-arrival warm-up, mantras) for tomorrow's rehearsal — use the template in the Ch.9 Review Card
-

Day 14 · Sun 9/20 — 🎯 Bi-week review + Exam-day dress rehearsal

Today's focus: Dress-rehearse the exam morning end-to-end and lock in the Ch.9 review card so Ch.10 starts clean.

Treat tomorrow's exam as if it were today.

- ☐ **Morning routine rehearsal:** wake up at the time you plan to wake up on exam day. Eat the same breakfast. Take the same transit (mentally walk through it if your test is at home).
 - ☐ **0:00–0:30** Anki + Shadowing — exactly as you would on exam morning (same source, same length)
 - ☐ **0:30–1:00 Light warm-up** — 1 Reading Module 1 set on **R-OFF-1** TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) free tier (no scoring, just to wake up the language brain). **Do NOT do a full mock.**
 - ☐ **1:00–1:30** Fill in the Ch.9 Review Card below (all 4 mock scores + goals self-check + residual errors) + finalize the exam-day routine doc
-

5 · Ch.9 Review Card (Day 14)

Ch.9 Review (9/20)

Mock scores

Mock	Date	R	L	S	W	Total	CEFR
1	9/7						
2	9/10						
3	9/14						
4	9/17						

- Trend: Mock 1 → Mock 4 score delta: ____
- Mocks 3 & 4 both ≥ 100 ? Yes / No
- Mock 4 vs Mock 3 within 3 points? Yes / No (stability check)

Goals self-check

- [] G1 4 mocks done
- [] G2 Mocks 3 & 4 ≥ 100
- [] G3 Every error attributed
- [] G4 Exam-day routine drafted and rehearsed
- [] G5 No timing overruns
- [] G6 Mock 4 stable vs Mock 3

Residual systematic errors (carry into Ch.10)

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Final Exam-Day Routine (draft)

- Wake time: ____
 - Breakfast: _____
 - Departure / setup: ____
 - On-arrival warm-up: _____ (Shadowing 5 min recommended)
 - During-test mantras: _____
-

6 • Common pitfalls

1. **Don't mock every day.** Mocks are exhausting. The 3-day cycle (mock / attribute / recover) is research-backed and matches your physical capacity.
2. **Attribution > new items.** A wrong answer with no attribution is a guaranteed repeat. A wrong answer with attribution is half-fixed already.
3. **AI scoring on Speaking/Writing has a 5-point error bar.** Don't panic over a 3-point dip between mocks. Look at the trend across all 4.
4. **The light day (Day 7) is non-negotiable.** Cumulative fatigue tanks Mocks 3–4. Trust the taper.
5. **Mock 4 within 3 points of Mock 3 = ready.** Score volatility means the system isn't stable yet. If Mock 4 swings ± 5 from Mock 3, examine: was it the mock content or your state?
6. **Don't compare to other test takers.** Your trend is the only data that matters.

Ch.10 · Final Taper (9/21 – 9/24)

Days: 4 (Day 1 = Mon 9/21 → Day 4 = Thu 9/24). Then 9/25 Fri = full rest day, 9/26 Sat = **EXAM DAY**. **Emphasis:** State management, micro-fixes only, no new heavy practice. **Skill coverage:** Each day touches all 4 skills lightly. Cadence drops every day. **Deliverables:** Walk into the exam **rested, calibrated, and confident**.

1 · The taper logic

You've done 19 weeks of work. The skills are built. The neural pathways are laid. **Adding new practice in the final week shows up as fatigue, not score gains.**

This stretch's job: 1. **Maintain** what you have (Anki reviews, light shadowing) 2. **Sharpen** one or two systematic errors from Ch.9 attribution 3. **Rest** — sleep, hydration, low cognitive load 4. **Rehearse** the exam day until it feels routine

What NOT to do: - No full mocks after Day 1 (Mon 9/21 mini-mock is the last one) - No new Anki cards from Day 2 (Tue 9/22) onward — reviews only - No new sources / decks / tools - No comparing yourself to other test-takers online

2 · Daily checklists (4 days)

Day 1 · Mon 9/21 — Last mini-mock + sticky-note error

Today's focus: Run the last timed integration; pick the one systematic error you'll attack for the remaining 3 days.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — 10 new (half normal) + reviews. Open **R-ANKI-4** (<https://apps.ankiweb.net/>) desktop / AnkiDroid → today's deck → cap new cards at 10 in deck options. **This is the last day for new cards.**
- ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing 15 min — re-use a previously-marked clip from **R-SHAD-1** (<https://ed.ted.com/lessons>) or **R-SHAD-2** (<https://www.ted.com/talks>); skip the recording pass to save energy.

- ☐ **0:30–1:45 Final mini-mock** — 1 Reading section + 1 Listening section (~60 min) + 1 Email + 1 Interview question. Use **R-OFF-1** ETS TestReady (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) for R/L (timed mode) and **R-AI-2** FluentPrep (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>) for Email + Interview scoring. Roughly 75 min total. **This is the last full session** — no pausing, no retries.
 - ☐ Score immediately and log raw scores under D1_final_mock in your error log. Identify **one** systematic error → write it on a physical sticky note → put it on your monitor. You will re-read it before every session for the next 3 days. **Don't dwell** on the score — if it dipped, that's normal pre-exam state.
-

Day 2 · Tue 9/22 — Targeted fix on the sticky note

Today's focus: Spend the whole session on the one error from Day 1 — nothing else.

- ☐ **0:00–0:30 Anki reviews only** (no new cards from today onward — set new cards/day = 0 in deck options) + 15-min Shadowing on a re-used clip.
 - ☐ **0:30–1:10 Targeted fix** — only the sticky-note error from Day 1. Examples:
 - If “L lecture inference questions” → drill 3 lecture sets on **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Listening → filter Lecture, and only re-do the inference items
 - If “Discussion stance ambiguity” → write 3 PEEL paragraphs focused on opening-sentence stance; score on **R-AI-2** (<https://www.fluentprep.online/>)
 - If “L&R memory drop on long sentences” → 10 sentence-level repetitions from **R-SHAD-3** (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>), 12+ word range; record and self-check
 - ☐ **1:10–1:30 1 Email** (10 min strict) on **R-OFF-1** Writing → Email — last Email practice. Log score and any grammar slip under D2_email.
-

Day 3 · Wed 9/23 — Logistics + dress rehearsal

Today's focus: Zero practice friction Saturday morning — every logistic decided today; rehearse the exam-morning routine end-to-end.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki reviews only. If review queue >60, do 60 and stop.
 - ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing — short, easy clip from **R-SHAD-4** BBC 6 Minute English (<https://www.bbc.co.uk/learningenglish/english/features/6-minute-english>) or a re-used favorite. Blind pass only.
 - ☐ **0:30–0:50 Dress rehearsal** — at the exam start time (08:00 ideally) walk through the full pre-exam routine: wake, breakfast, brush, get dressed, transit/setup. Time it end-to-end. Note any gaps to fix tomorrow.
 - ☐ **0:50–1:20 Logistics check** (everything decided NOW, not exam morning):
 - Test admission ticket / confirmation email — printed AND saved as screenshot on phone
 - ID document — passport ready, placed with ticket by the front door
 - Test center location + transit time + parking (or at-home: room cleared, browser/system check completed via **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → Home Test → System Check)
 - Exam-day breakfast bought / planned — same one used before any Ch.9 mock
 - Clothes laid out (layers — test rooms run cold)
 - Phone alarm set for wake time + backup alarm 5 min later
 - ☐ **1:20–1:30** Re-read the sticky note + rewrite it in one sharper sentence if needed. **Don't add new fixes** — only refine the original one.
-

Day 4 · Thu 9/24 — Pure taper

Today's focus: Keep the language brain warm; protect sleep and energy. 2 days out — drop the load.

- ☐ **0:00–0:15** Anki — reviews only, queue capped at 60. Verify new cards/day is still set to 0 in deck options.
- ☐ **0:15–0:30** Shadowing 15 min — your favorite clip, low effort. Skip the recording pass; just transcript-along.
- ☐ **0:30–0:45** Listen to one **R-SHAD-3** (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>) 60-sec Science episode + summarize aloud in one sentence. Don't grade yourself.
- ☐ **0:45–1:00** Read one **R-REAL-1** Economist Espresso brief (<https://www.economist.com/the-world-in-brief>) — 5 min, single read-through, no note-taking.

- ☐ No drills. No mocks. **Get 8+ hours of sleep tonight.** Caffeine cutoff by 14:00.
-

3 · Pre-exam rest day · Fri 9/25 (1 day out)

Today's focus: Rest > anything else. The work is done.

- ☐ **5 min** Anki reviews if there's a queue. If queue >30, do 30 and stop. No new cards.
 - ☐ **5 min** Shadow a 1-min clip from **R-SHAD-3** (<https://www.scientificamerican.com/podcast/60-second-science/>) — blind pass only. This is the only language work today.
 - ☐ **Re-confirm logistics** from Day 3 (ticket, ID, transit, breakfast, alarms). Place everything by the door.
 - ☐ **No screens after 22:00.** Sleep early. Caffeine cutoff by 12:00.
-

4 · 🎯 EXAM DAY · Sat 9/26

08:00 AM — TOEFL iBT 2026

Pre-exam (60–90 min before)

- ☐ Wake at your rehearsed time (same as Ch.9 mocks and Day 3 dress rehearsal).
- ☐ Same breakfast as your rehearsals — do not experiment.
- ☐ **5-min Shadowing** — your favorite clip on phone. Wakes up the language brain. One blind pass, headphones on.
- ☐ **2-min Anki review** — quick scan of yesterday's reviews in AnkiWeb (<https://ankiweb.net>) or AnkiDroid. No new cards.
- ☐ Mantra: *"Module 1 accuracy. Single-pass. Slow start. Trust the work."* Say it once aloud before leaving.

During the exam

- **Reading:** First 2 items, **deliberately read slowly**. Reset your reading speed before pace-setting. Target ≥ 80% Module 1 accuracy.
- **Listening:** Notes from the first sentence. Don't wait to see if "it'll be important."
- **Speaking:**
 - Listen & Repeat — breathe before each item, stay in the speaker's rhythm
 - Interview — first 5 sec: state your stance clearly, then unfold

- **Writing:**

- Email — greet / context / ask / close. Stop at 100 words.
- Discussion — PEEL: Point in opening sentence.
- Build a Sentence — read each option twice.

After the exam

- Walk away. Don't re-litigate items with yourself or others.
 - Eat something good.
 - Score arrives in 72 hours via **R-OFF-1** (<https://www.ets.org/toefl/test-takers/ibt/prepare/toefl-testready.html>) → My Tests → Score Report.
-

5 · Post-Exam reflection (within 72 hours)

Exam Reflection

Score (when it arrives)

- Reading: __ / 30 (CEFR __)
- Listening: __ / 30 (CEFR __)
- Speaking: __ / 30 (CEFR __)
- Writing: __ / 30 (CEFR __)
- Total: __ / 120
- CEFR Overall: __

Comparison to Ch.9 mocks

- Best mock score: ____
- Real exam score: ____
- Delta: ____

What worked from this book

-
-

What I'd change for a retake (if any)

-
-

6 · If the score isn't what you wanted

1. **Wait 72 hours** before deciding anything. Initial reactions are biased by exhaustion.

2. **Look at the section breakdown.** A retake should target the weakest single section — not “study everything more.”
 3. **Retake window:** TOEFL iBT allows next-attempt registration 3 days after; the next test date is typically 1–3 weeks out. ETS scoring rules permit unlimited retakes.
 4. **Re-use this book.** Treat the weak section as a new Ch.2–Ch.9 mini-cycle (6 weeks). Skip the rest.
-

7 · The one thing to remember

You spent 130 days building infrastructure: Anki habit, Shadowing reflex, error attribution, weekly rotation, mock execution, taper discipline. The score is downstream of the system.

Trust the system. Execute the test.

Good luck.